SABEEL INSTITUTE

سبيل

LMS

User Manual

App version 0.1.1 · October 2026

Welcome! This guide explains everything the Sabeel Institute LMS app can do — from playing a class you missed and handing in an assignment to taking attendance, grading, and tracking who has caught up. It is organized by role: **students** start with Part 1; **staff** (managers and admins) add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick "How do I…?" index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (https://oursabeel-lms.web.app) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. Every screen in this guide is shown twice: once **on a phone** and once **on a computer**, so you can recognize it wherever you are. Both are captures of the website, at a phone's width and a laptop's; the Android app draws the same screens, minus the one thing Section 2.11 calls out.

The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **A recording is one class meeting, as the class made it.** Some are audio only; some also have video — the speaker and the slides, or just the slides — and you choose which to play. A long class may come in parts. Recordings stream in the app; nothing is downloaded to fill up your phone, and each play link is freshly issued and expires, so recordings stay inside the app.
2. **The app is for catching up on a class you were excused from.** Staff take **attendance** for each meeting. If they mark you **excused**, that meeting's recording opens to you and becomes *required* — it appears on your **To do** list with a date to finish it by, and closes again after it. If you were **present**, you don't need it. If you were **absent** without being excused, it isn't opened to you. Being excused is the whole of it.
3. **You mark a recording complete yourself.** The app saves your place and shows how much you've played, but *you* decide when you're done — it is on your honor. (The one rule: you have to have pressed play at least once.)
4. **Staff can see who has caught up.** For every recording there is a ledger: of the students who were excused, who has finished and who missed the date — plus, for the record, who was present and who was absent. Staff can export it and, with a written reason, mark a completion on someone's behalf.
5. **Assignments are handed in here too.** A teacher posts an assignment to the whole class with a date to hand it in by. You write your answer, attach files or a photo of your page, and hand it in. Your teacher grades it and returns it — and you see the grade only once it is returned.

6. **Everything important is written down.** Approvals, overrides, edits and returned grades are recorded in an audit history that admins can review.

That’s the whole system. Everything below is detail.

Finding your way around

The app has a **bar along the bottom** on a phone and a **narrow strip of icons down the left** on a computer. It is the same set of places either way, and it is always there — so wherever you are, you are one tap from anywhere else.

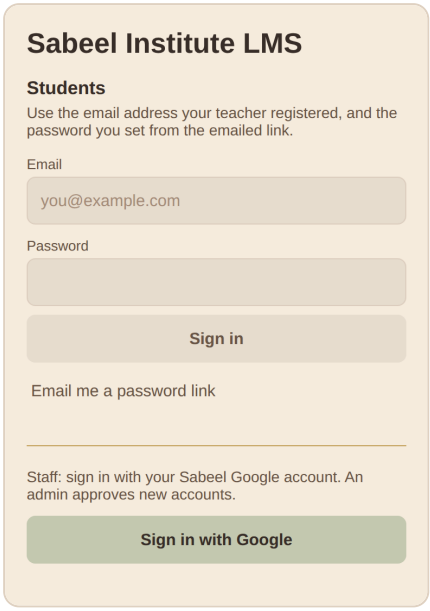
Students have **To do**, **Classes** and **More**. Staff have **Today**, **Courses**, **Library**, **People** and **More**.

More holds the things you need occasionally rather than daily: notification settings, the privacy policy, signing out, and — for students — changing your password. Admins also reach the audit history there.

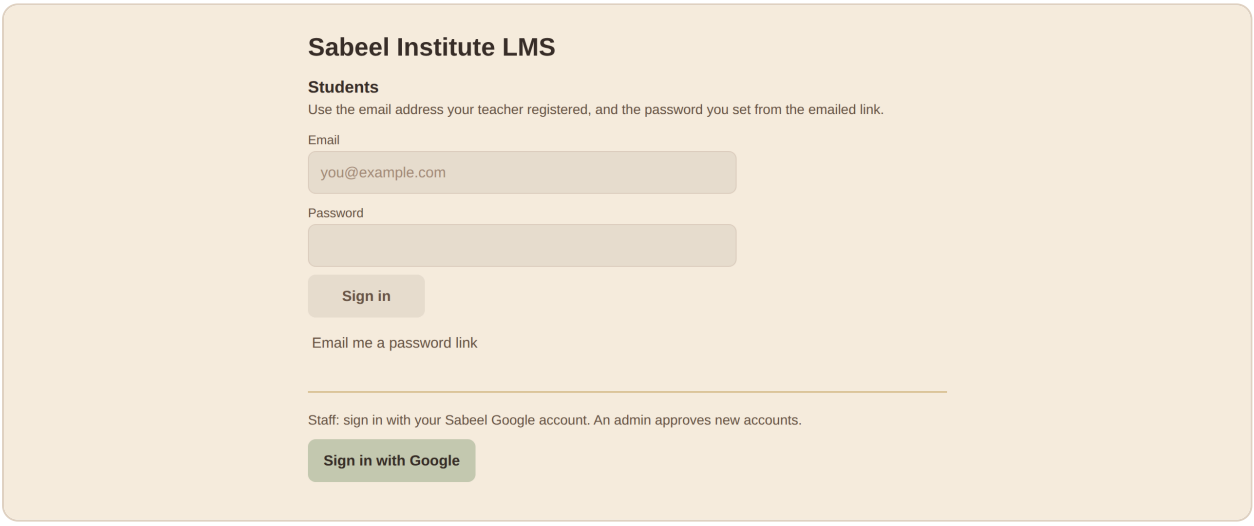
When something is playing, a slim bar shows what it is with a play/pause button — above the tabs on a phone, along the foot of the window on a computer. You can move around the app and it keeps playing; tap the bar to go back to the full player.

Part 1 — For students

1.1 Signing in



On a phone



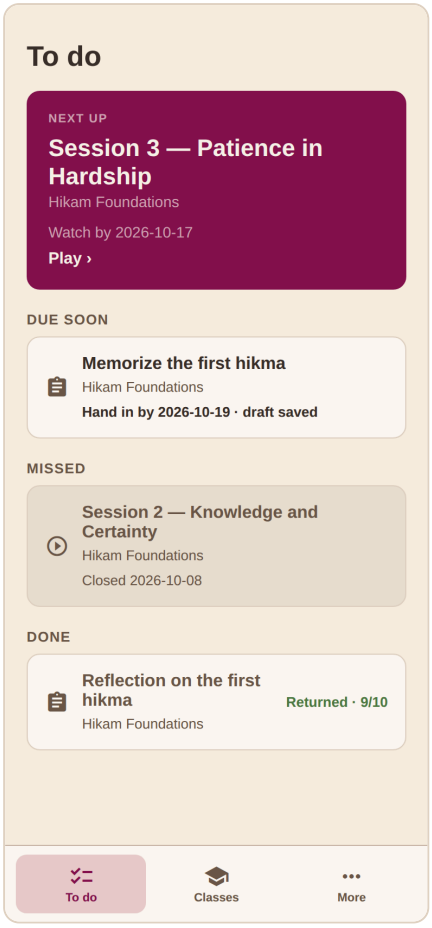
On a computer

Open the app or the website. Under **Students**, enter the **email address your teacher registered** and your password, then tap **Sign in**.

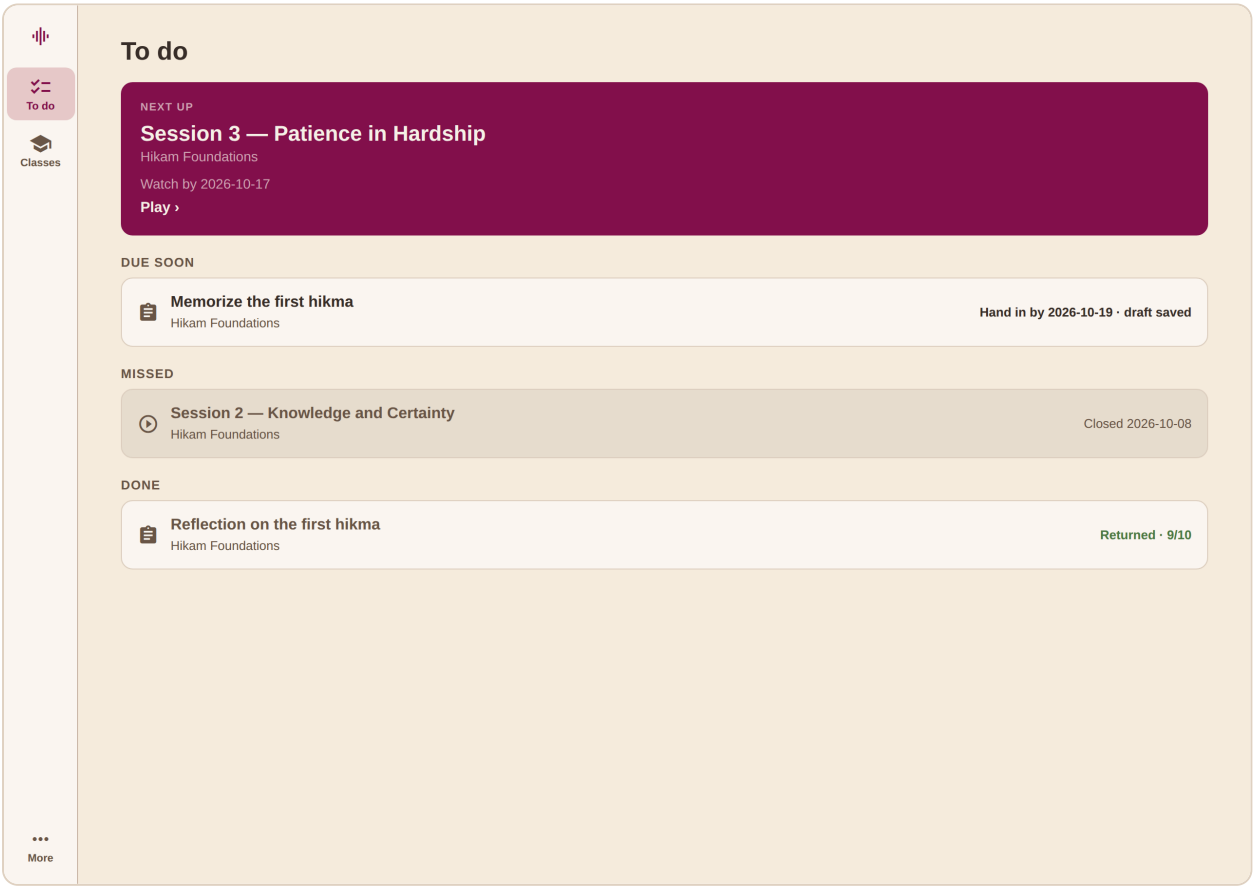
Your first password comes from an email. When your teacher creates your account, the app sends you a “set your password” link — open it, choose a password, and you’re ready. If you never received it or the link has expired, tap **Email me a password link** on this screen to get a fresh one.

The **Staff** line at the bottom is only for teachers and administrators — you don’t need it.

1.2 To do — everything you owe



On a phone



On a computer

To do is the first thing the app opens on. It is everything you owe on one list — the **recordings** you need to play and the **assignments** you need to hand in — soonest first.

A recording is opened to you when your teacher marks you *excused* for that class. That is the whole rule. If you were there, you don't need it; if you missed a class without being excused, it isn't opened to you. So this one list is both what you *may* play and what you *need* to play — there is no separate archive to go hunting through. **Assignments** come to everyone in the class when the teacher posts them, and to anyone who joins the class by the due date.

The one to do next is at the top, in full — the nearest date still ahead, recording or assignment. Late work you can still hand in sits right under it. Everything else is grouped so nothing slips past you:

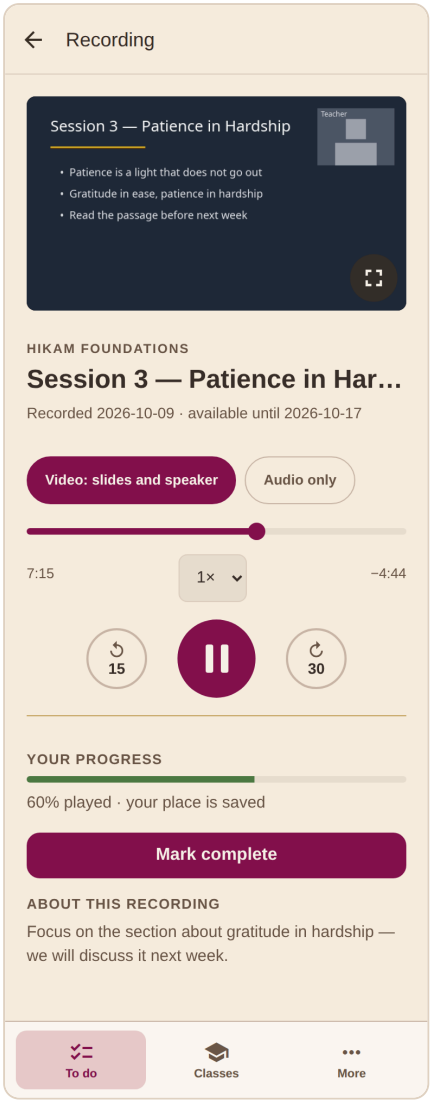
- **Past due** — assignments whose date has passed but which your teacher still accepts, late.
- **Due soon** — due within the next week.
- **Upcoming** — further off.
- **Missed** — closed, with the date it closed. Nothing can be done about these, so they are set quietly rather than as an alarm.
- **Archived** — the class has been archived and its recordings closed, so these are no longer required and cannot be played. Quiet, like Missed.
- **Done** — what you finished or handed in over the last two weeks. Your class's page keeps the whole record.

Each card shows its title, which class it's from, and its date: **Watch by** for a recording with video, **Listen by** for one that is audio only, **Hand in by** for an assignment. Tap a card to open it — except a Missed or Archived recording, which can no longer be played and so does not open.

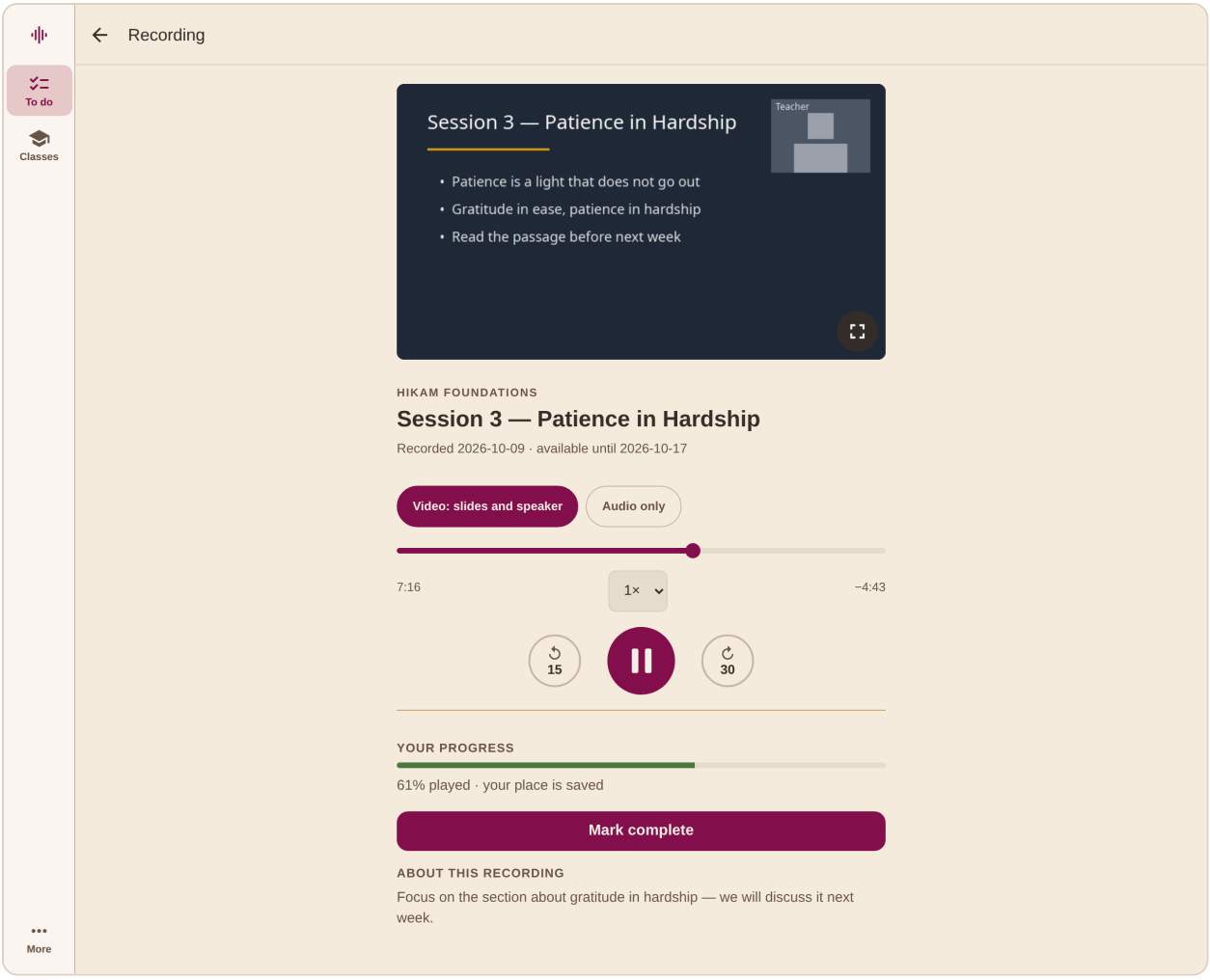
Every recording has a closing date. After it passes you can no longer play that recording — the card stays on your list marked *Missed*, so you can still see what it was, but the recording is closed. Opening it shows **Your record**: how much of it you played, and whether it was marked complete. Nothing you did is lost when a recording closes. If you need it reopened, ask your teacher: they can move the date.

One thing worth knowing: if you finish a recording and mark it complete *before* the date, it counts as complete for good. It is never turned into a “missed” the next day.

1.3 Playing a recording



On a phone



On a computer

The title is at the top. A long one slides slowly along its line — or, if your phone is set to reduce motion, ends in "…" — and tapping it shows it whole; tap again to fold it back. Under it are the day of the class and the last day you can play it.

When a recording has video, the picture is at the top of the player. Tap the **full-screen icon** in its bottom corner to fill the screen with it. On an Android phone, leaving the app while a video plays shrinks it into a small window over your other apps; on any phone the sound carries on when the screen is locked.

Choosing what to play. A recording may have more than one version of the same class:

- **Video: slides and speaker** — the teacher and the shared screen.
- **Video: slides only** — just the shared screen.
- **Audio only** — the sound, and the smallest download.

The buttons under the player switch between them, and you carry on from the same moment — switching to audio on a walk and back to video at home loses nothing. A video uses far more mobile data than audio, so on a phone plan, audio only is the thrifty choice.

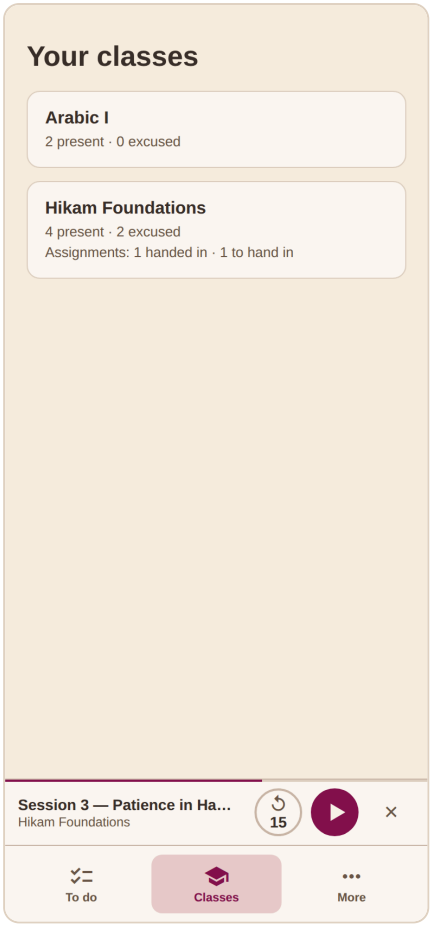
Parts. A long class is sometimes recorded in parts — for example when the recording was stopped for a break. The parts are listed under the player, in order; the next part starts on its own when one ends, and you can tap any part to go to it.

The controls are the ones you'd expect from a podcast app:

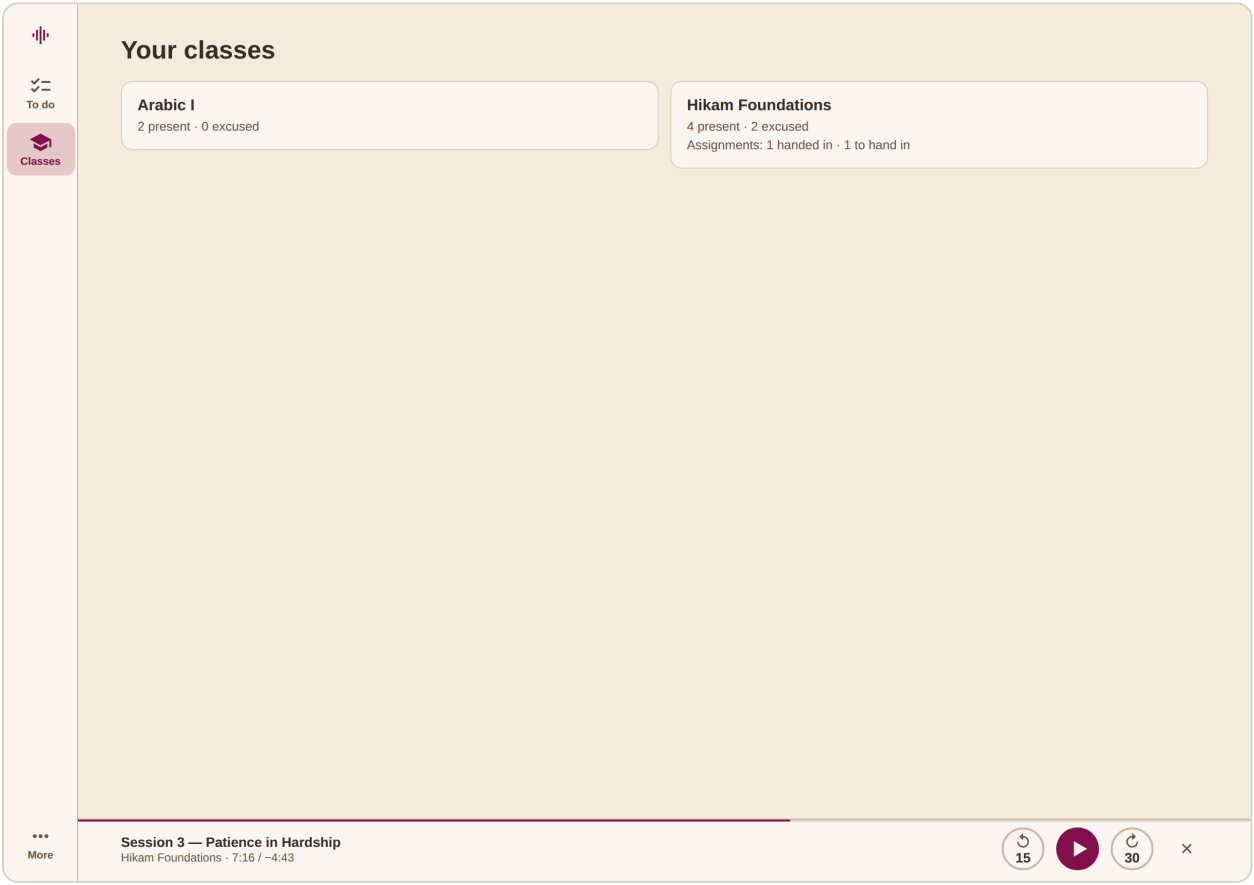
- **The big round button** plays and pauses.
- The two side buttons **skip back 15 seconds** and **skip ahead 30 seconds** — handy for re-hearing a point or moving past a pause.
- Drag the **progress bar** to jump anywhere. The times below it show how far in you are and how much is left.
- **The speed**, beside the times — 1× up to 2× — changes how fast it plays without changing the pitch.

A line under the controls says how much of the recording you've played. **Your place is saved automatically**, so you can stop on your phone on the bus and pick up on your laptop at home — it remembers where you were.

If the teacher left a note, it appears under **About this recording** — often "focus on this part" or "we'll discuss this next week."



On a phone



On a computer

You can leave this screen without stopping playback. Go and check your attendance record or open another class — a slim bar keeps showing what's playing, with play/pause and a 15-second skip back, and tapping it brings you back here. On a computer that bar carries the skip forward and the times as well. Closing it with the × is what stops playback.

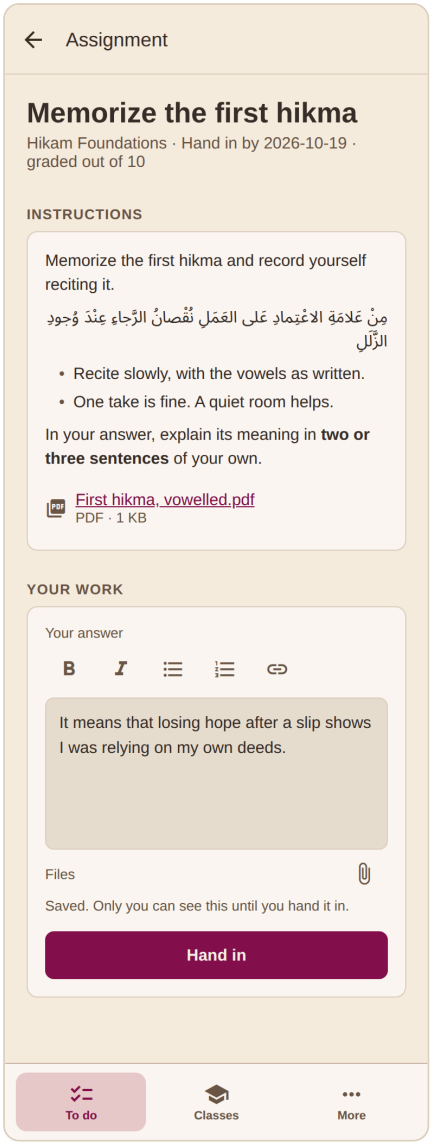
1.4 Marking a recording complete

The **Mark complete** button is at the bottom of the player. Tap it when you've finished, and the recording moves to **Done**.

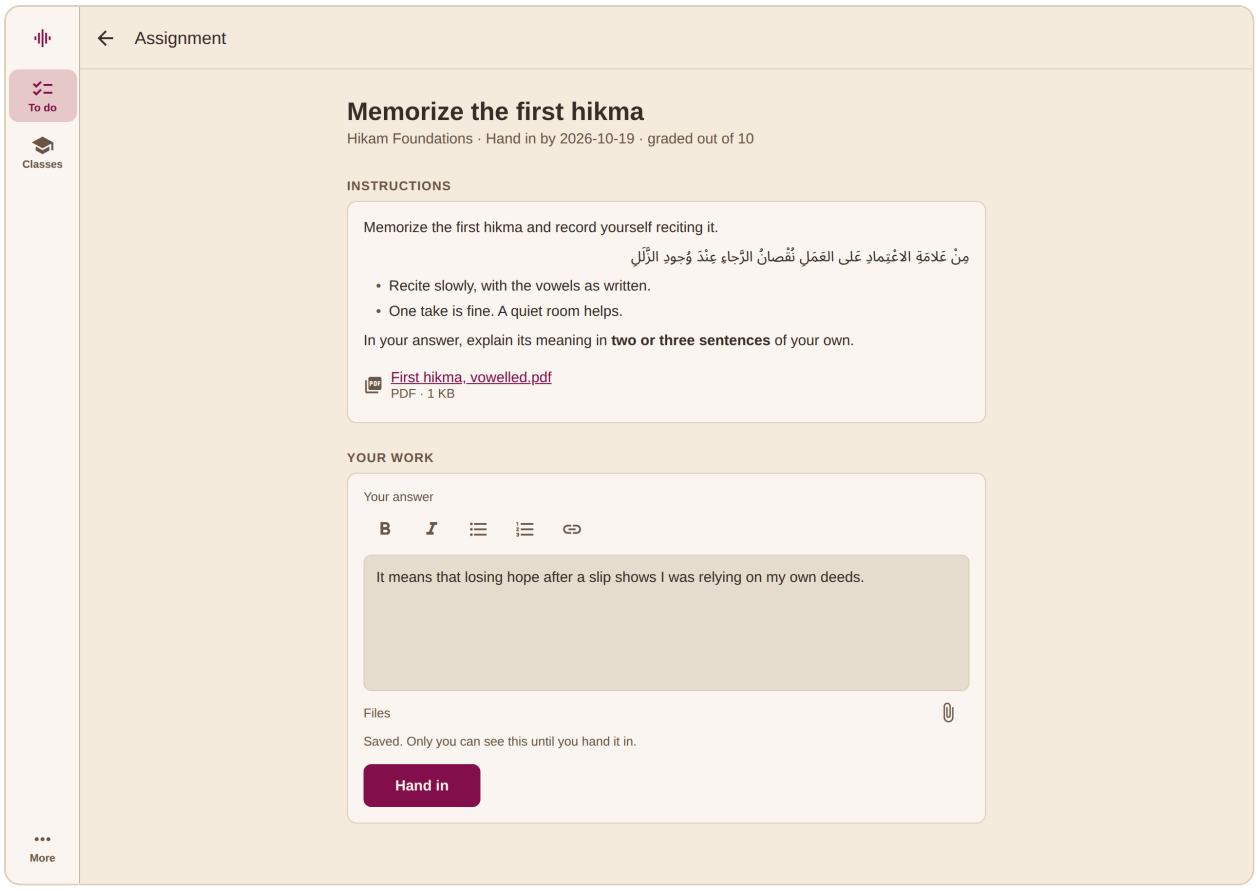
A few things worth knowing:

- **It's on your honor.** The app doesn't force you to play every second — it trusts you to mark complete when you're genuinely done. The progress bar is there to help *you* keep your place, not to police you.
- **You do have to press play first.** The button only unlocks once you've started the recording — you can't mark something complete you've never opened.
- **Changed your mind?** You can open a completed recording again and play more; marking complete isn't a locked door.

1.5 Assignments — your answer, your files, Hand in



On a phone



On a computer

An assignment is work your teacher sets for the whole class: a reflection, a recitation, a worksheet. It appears on **To do** with the date to hand it in by, and opens to your teacher's **instructions** and any **files** they attached — a worksheet to print, a reading, a recording to listen to. Tap a file to open it.

Your work is under the instructions:

- **Your answer** — write it right there. Bold, italics, lists and links are on the bar above the box, and Arabic runs right to left. Sometimes the answer is all there is: a question put to the class, a few sentences.
- **Files** — tap the paperclip to add a document, a picture or an audio recording. On a phone it asks where from: **Choose files**, or **Take a photo** of a page you wrote out by hand. Up to ten files, 25 MB each; no video. Tap a file to open it, and the bin beside it to take it off.

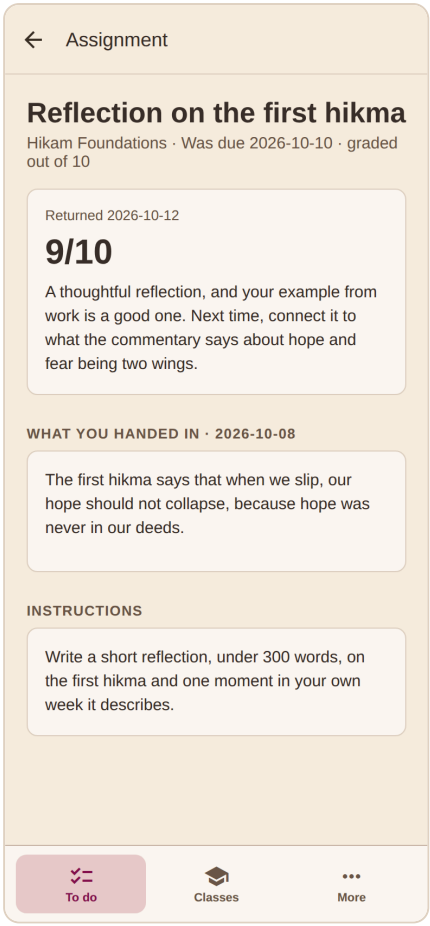
A file opens in a tab of its own. One your browser cannot show there — a Word file, or a PDF on a phone without a PDF viewer — is saved to your downloads instead, under its own name.

Everything is saved as you go, on the server — start on your phone and finish on the website, or leave and come back later — and nobody sees it until you hand it in. If you try to leave while a file is still uploading, the app asks first, because leaving stops the upload.

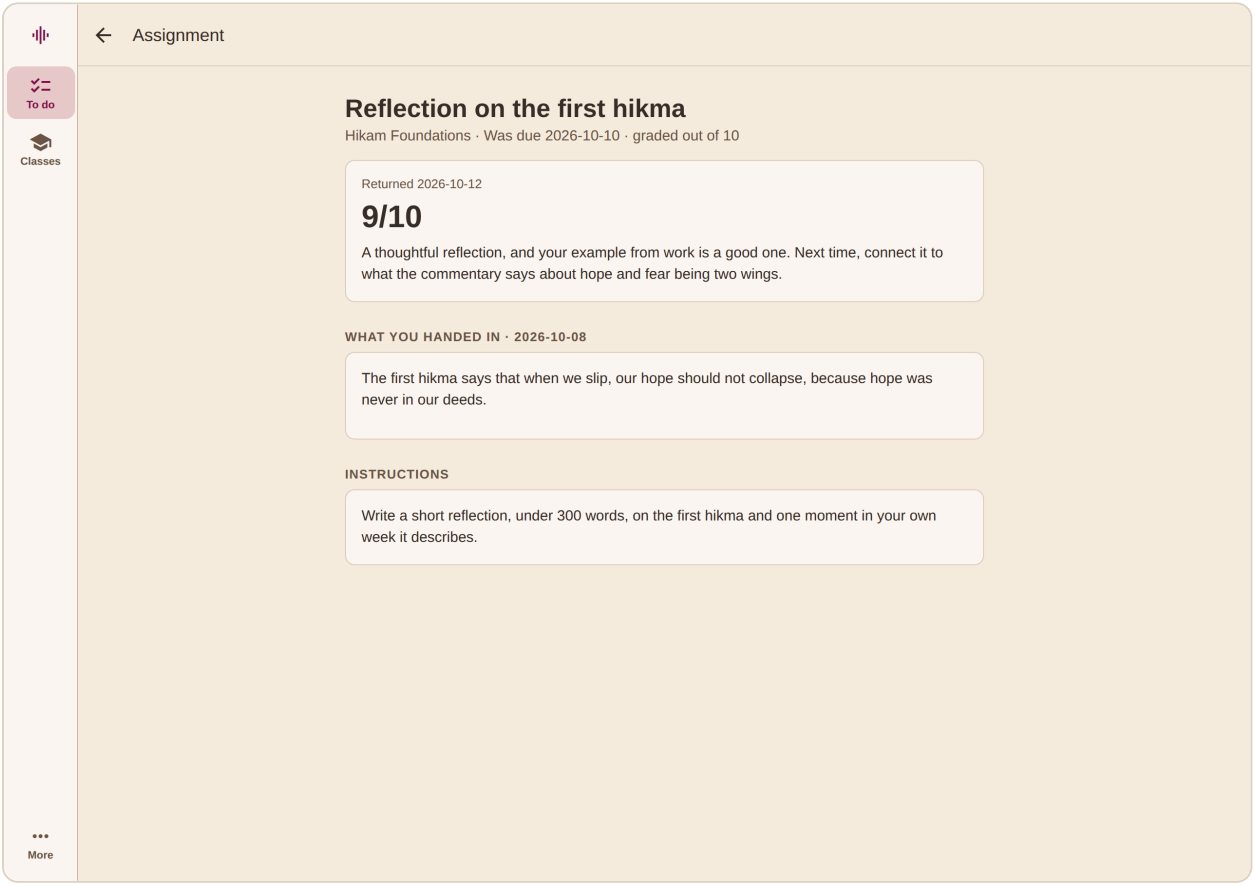
When it’s ready, tap **Hand in**. It needs an answer, a file, or both. Your teacher sees exactly what is on your screen at that moment.

Changed your mind? Until the due date, and while your teacher hasn’t returned it, tap **Take back**, beside what you handed in, change what you need to, and hand it in again.

Late. If your teacher accepts late work, you can still hand it in after the due date until the date the screen gives you; it is marked late. After that it is **missed**, and the screen says so. If you need more time, ask your teacher — they can give you a date of your own.



On a phone

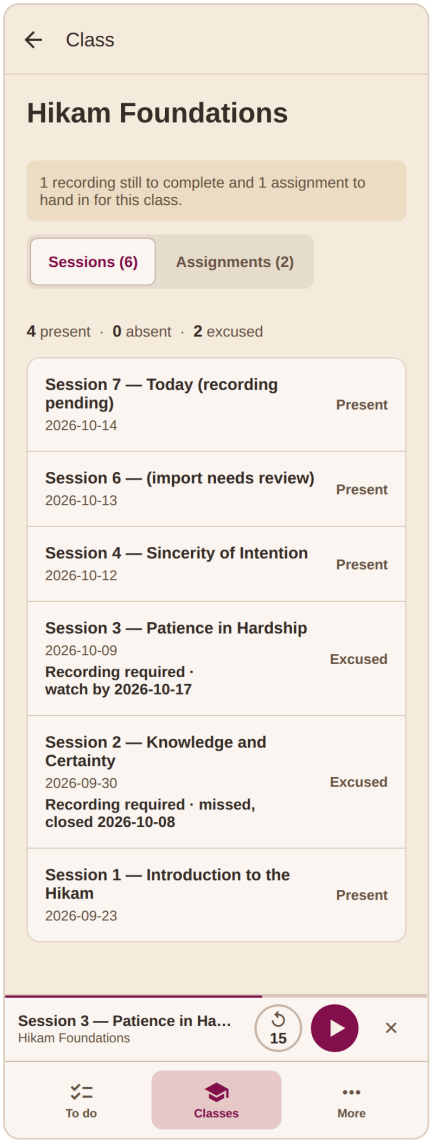


On a computer

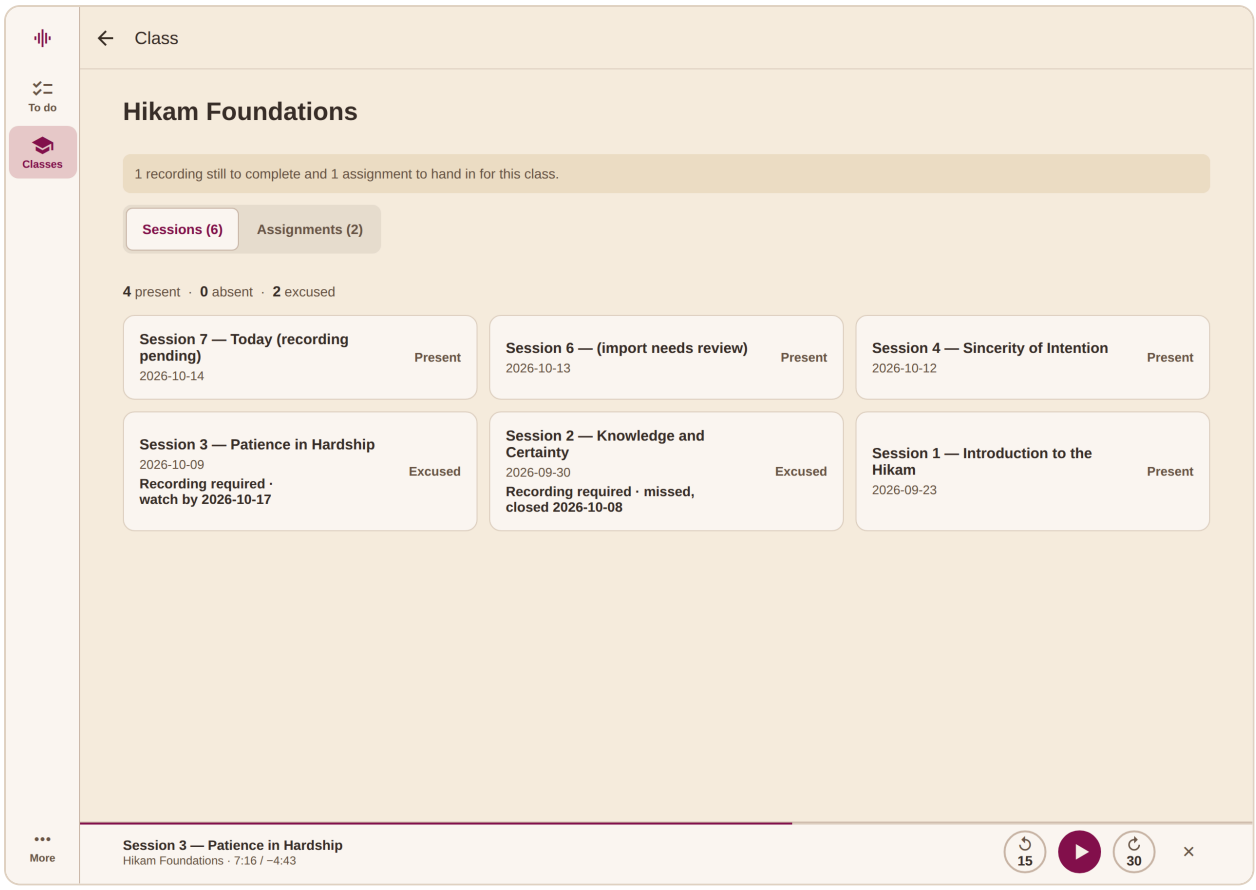
Returned. When your teacher returns your work, your grade and their feedback appear at the top, and the app tells you it’s back — never the grade itself, because a lock screen isn’t private. You see a grade only once it is returned. If your teacher asks for **another try**, the assignment goes back on To do with a new date, and your first attempt and its feedback stay underneath.

Now and then an assignment is marked **not required** for you, with your teacher’s reason. You can still read it.

1.6 Your classes



On a phone



On a computer

Tap **Classes** in the navigation to see the classes you're enrolled in — each one shows your attendance and your assignments at a glance. Classes that have finished wait in a closed **Finished** section at the bottom; tap it to open it.

Tap a class to open its page. A line at the top says what you owe in it, and it has two tabs:

- **Sessions** — **your own attendance**. At the top, one line counts the meetings you were **present** for, **absent** from, and **excused** from. Below it, every meeting your teacher recorded you in, newest first, with the date and your own mark. Where you were excused, the row also says that a recording was required and whether you've completed it.
- **Assignments** — every assignment in the class and where it stands: to do, handed in, returned with its grade, or missed, under a line counting what you handed in and what you missed.

Two things this page is not: it isn't where you play a recording (that's **To do**), and it never shows anyone else's attendance or work.

1.7 Changing your password

Tap **More**, then **Change password**. The app emails you a link to set a new one — the same kind of link you used when your account was first created. Your account is created for you by the institute; you can't sign yourself up, and there's nothing to create here.

1.8 Playing on a spotty connection

The app is built to survive a bad signal. If you mark a recording complete while you're offline or your connection drops, the app **holds onto that** and syncs it the moment you're back online — even if you close the app in between. You may briefly see a "pending" state; that just means "saved on this device, not yet sent." You don't have to do anything; it sorts itself out.

Streaming the recording itself does need a connection, so for a long class on the go, a stable network (or Wi-Fi) is your friend — and audio only needs far less of it than video. Where you got to is saved even if your phone is locked and the signal comes and goes; it reaches your account the next time the app is open with a connection.

1.9 Notifications

The app can send you five kinds of message, and no more. Tap **More**, then **Notifications**, to turn any of them off:

- **A recording is ready for me** — when a class you were excused from has a recording for you. Worth leaving on: it's the only way you'll know one has appeared.
- **Last day for a recording** — on the morning of the day a recording closes, if you haven't finished it.
- **New assignments** — when a teacher posts an assignment for you, or moves its due date.
- **Last day to hand in** — on the morning an assignment is due, if you haven't handed it in.
- **Work returned** — when your teacher returns your work, asks for another try, or changes a grade they returned.

All of them start switched on. There's deliberately no message *after* something closes: by then there'd be nothing you could do about it. **Tapping a message opens what it's about** — the recording or the assignment. On an Android phone the app's messages are listed as **Class alerts**

and deadlines in its notification settings.

A message is shown whether the app is open or closed, on the phone and on the website. While you're in the app — playing a recording, say — it appears as a banner, without a sound.

Your choices follow you — they apply on every device you sign in on. Reaching this device needs its permission as well. The app offers to set that up once, on To do after you sign in; you can also tap **Enable notifications** on this screen at any time. If it says they are blocked, use **Open settings** on a phone, or allow them from the site settings behind the icon in your browser's address bar. If it says this device can't show them at all, either the browser doesn't support them or setting them up didn't finish — try again from this screen, and if it keeps saying that, tell Faisal.

Part 2 — For staff

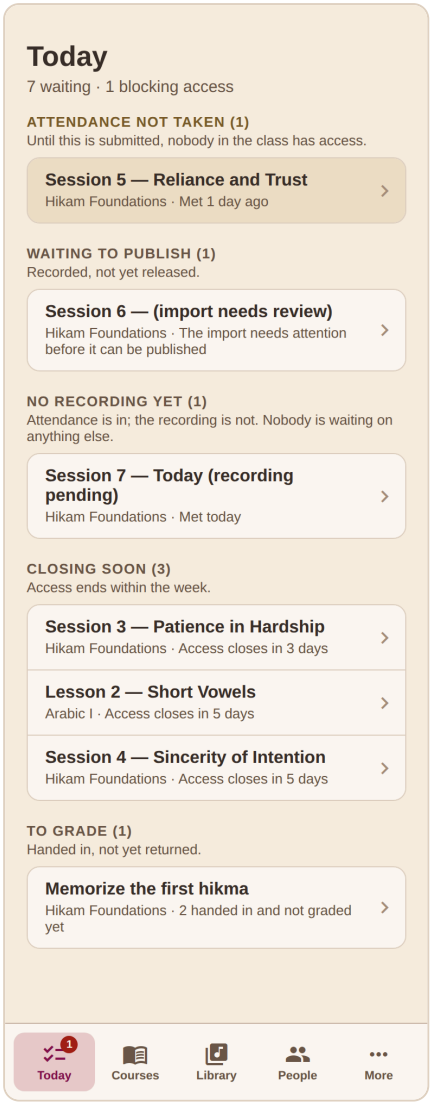
Managers and admins both use this section. A few actions are admin-only and are marked; managers see only the courses they've been assigned to.

2.1 Signing in and getting approved

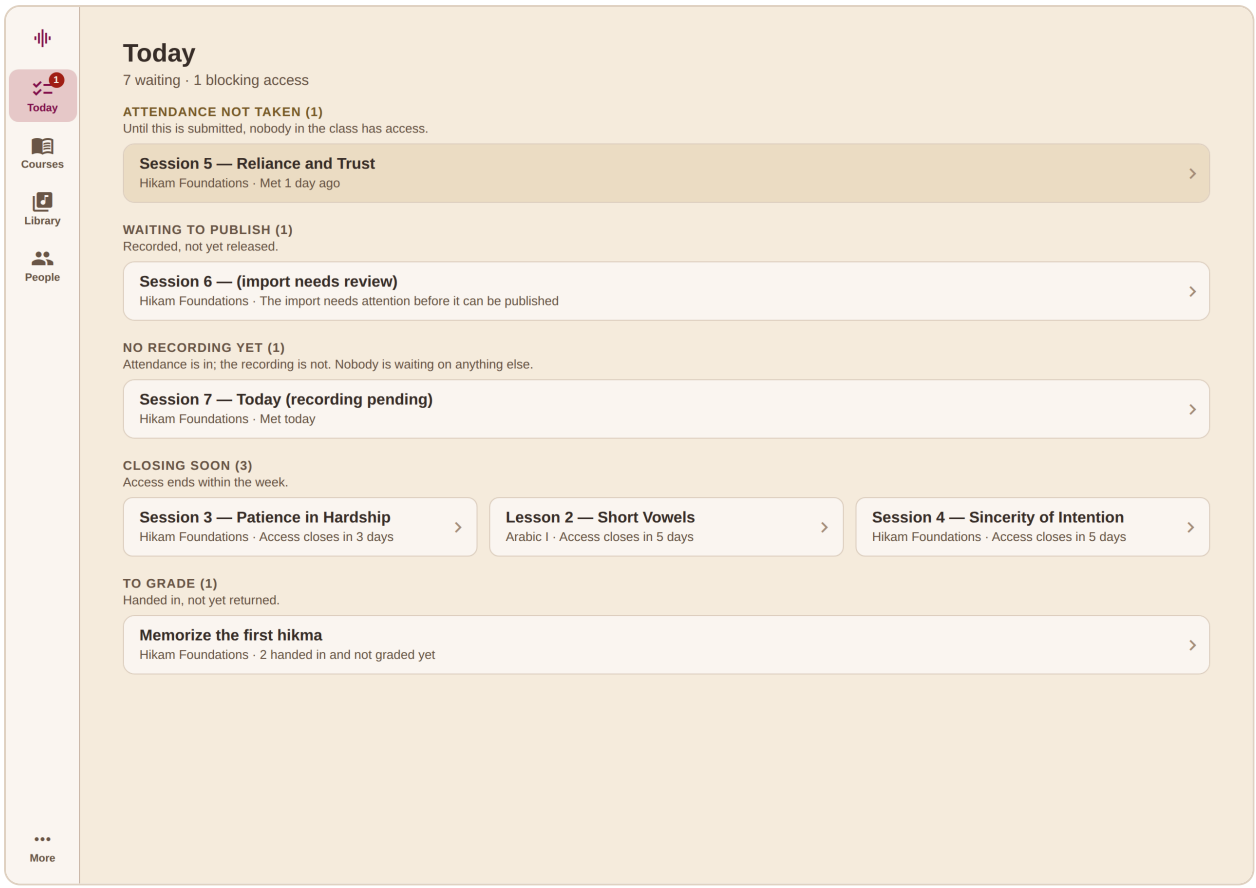
Staff sign in differently from students. On the sign-in screen, use **Sign in with Google** with your Sabeel Google account.

The first time, you'll wait for approval. New staff accounts start as *pending* — an administrator has to approve you and choose your role before you can do anything. The screen updates by itself the moment they do; you do not need to sign in again. (If you're the very first administrator, that step was done for you during setup.)

2.2 Today — what’s waiting



On a phone



On a computer

The app opens on **Today**: everything across your courses that is waiting on you, most urgent first, under a heading that says what to do. Every row is a link straight to the screen where you do it, and says which class it is and how long it has waited.

- **Attendance not taken** — a class has met and nobody has submitted the register. This is first and it's the one entry the screen tints, because until it's submitted **nobody in that class has access to the recording** — and nothing else on any screen would tell you.
- **Waiting to publish** — a recording is added but not out: still a draft, an import that needs attention, or one that was published and has since been unpublished or archived.
- **No recording yet** — attendance is in, the recording isn't.
- **Closing soon** — access to a recording ends within the week; a good moment to see who still hasn't finished.
- **To grade** — work handed in and not yet graded, in the courses you manage (an admin sees it only for courses they are a manager of, so it never buries the registers). It is never in the count on the tab. Tap a row to grade (Section 2.15).

The number on the **Today** tab counts what is blocking access right now: a register not yet submitted, and a recording that was published and has since been taken back — unpublished, or archived before its due date. A draft that has never been published is waiting on you but is blocking nobody, so it is in the list without being in the count. Archiving *after* the due date took nothing away from anyone, so it is simply filing and says nothing here.

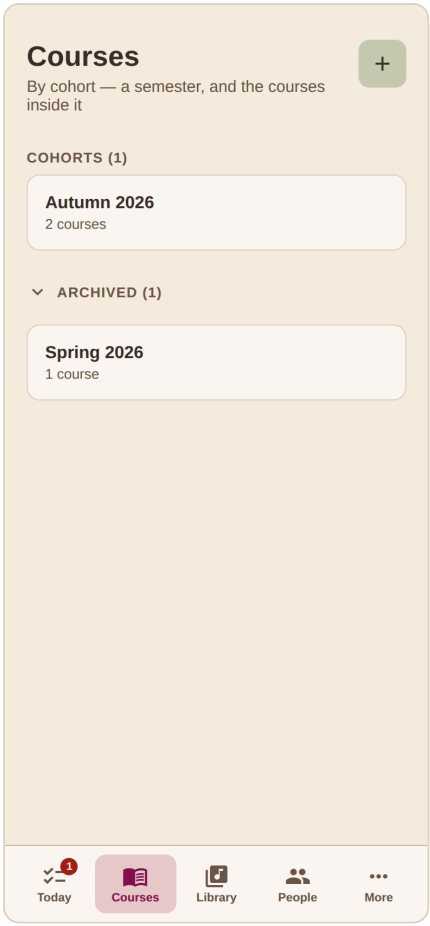
If you run more courses than one screen can watch at once, Today says so above the list — the rest are still there under **Courses**, they are just not in this count.

A row disappears the moment you close the gap, and the count goes with it. An empty Today is the answer, not a blank screen: it means attendance is in, every recording is published, nothing closes this week, and no work is waiting to be graded.

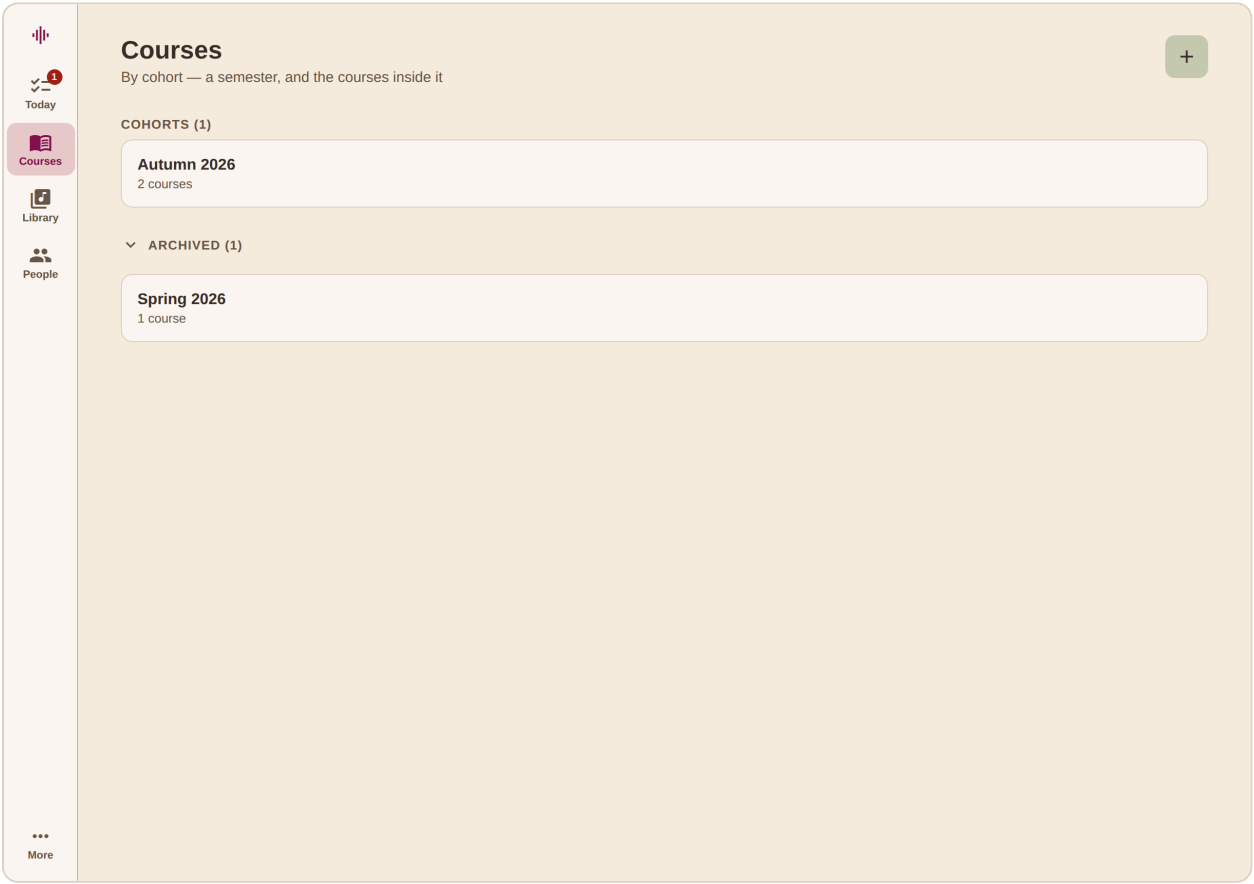
The rest of the navigation is the structure: **Courses** (cohorts and their courses for an admin, your own courses for a manager), **Library**, **People**, and **More**.

2.3 Cohorts, courses, and a course at a glance

The structure is **Cohort → Course → Session → Recording**, with **assignments** on each course too. A **cohort** is a term or intake (like “Autumn 2026”). A **course** is a subject taught over that term. A **session** is one dated meeting of the course, and a **recording** is that meeting as the class made it: audio, and often video too. An **assignment** is work set for the course (Sections 2.14 and 2.15).



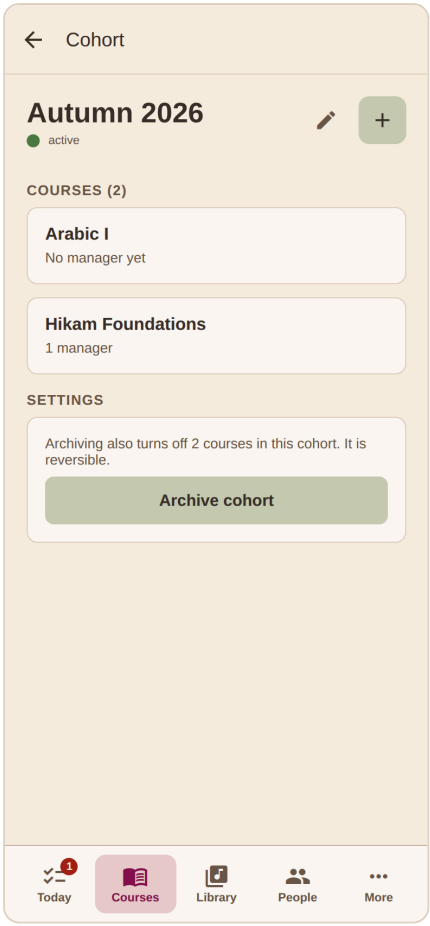
On a phone



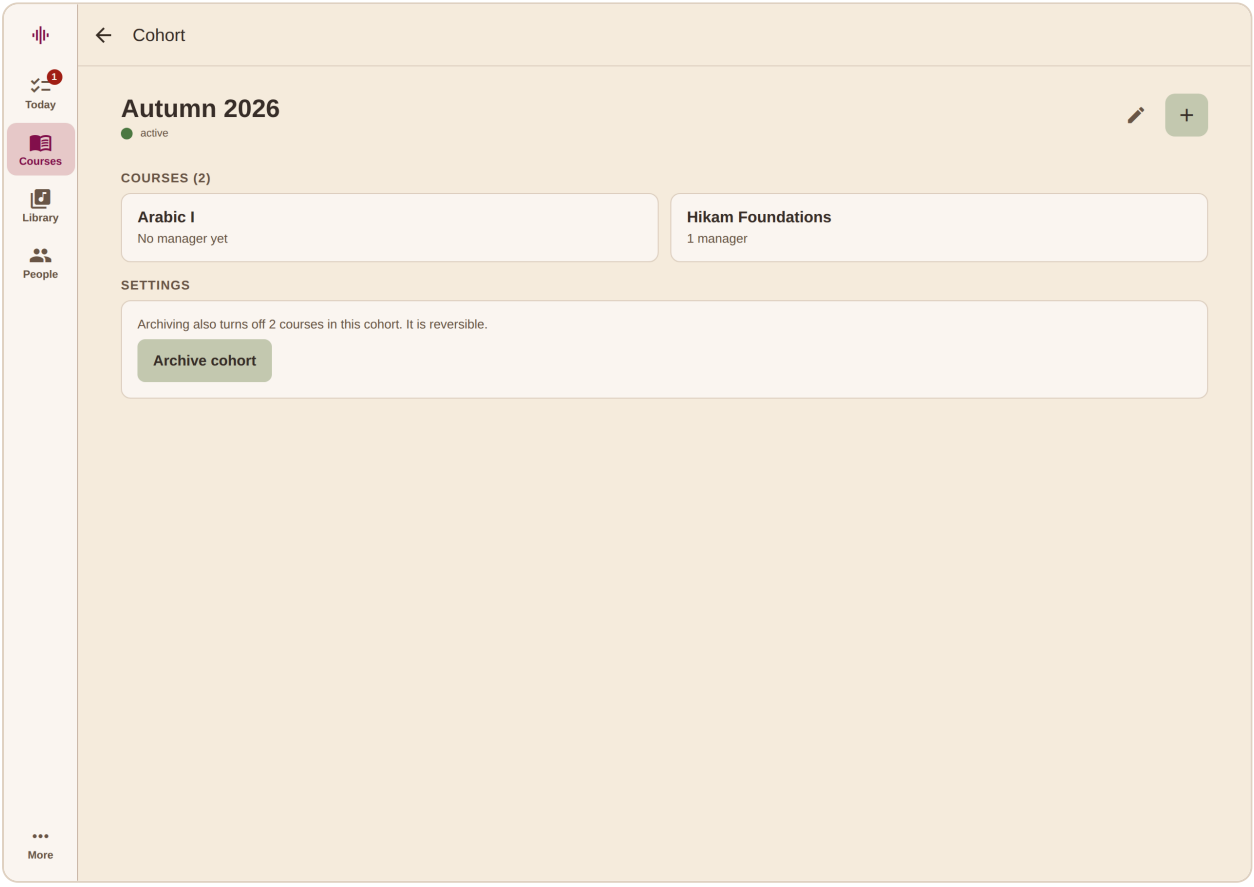
On a computer

Finished terms move into an **Archived** section at the bottom of the cohort list — tap the heading to open it.

Open a cohort to see **its courses**, and open a course to work with it. Archived courses wait in a closed **Archived** section at the bottom; tap the heading to open it. The same goes for **Your courses**, a manager's list. Shaping the structure is for **admins only**: the **pencil** beside the cohort's name renames it, and **Settings**, under the courses, archives it — the same way a course is renamed and archived from the course page. Archiving a cohort turns off every course in it; reactivating puts each course back to the setting it had.

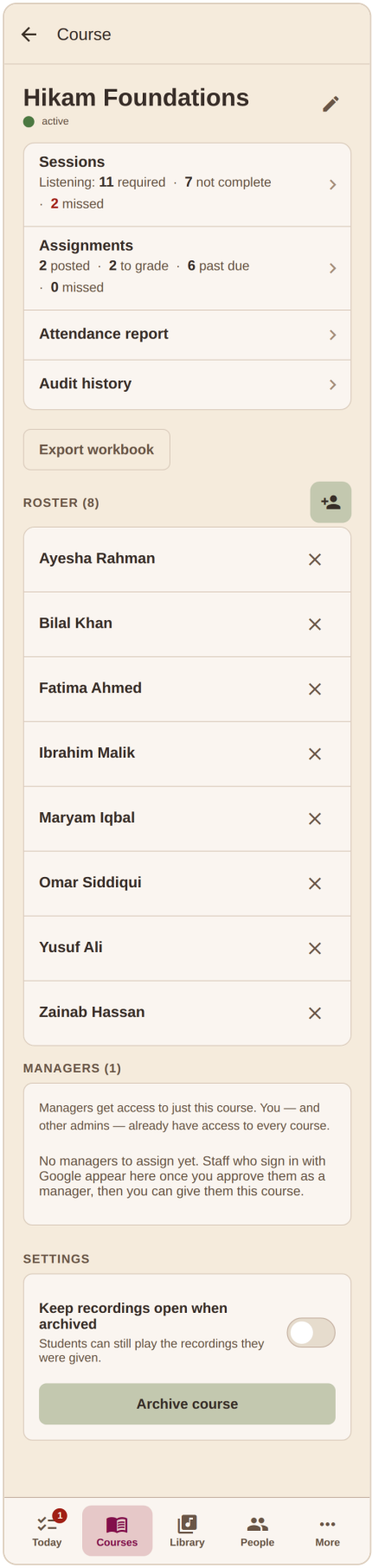


On a phone

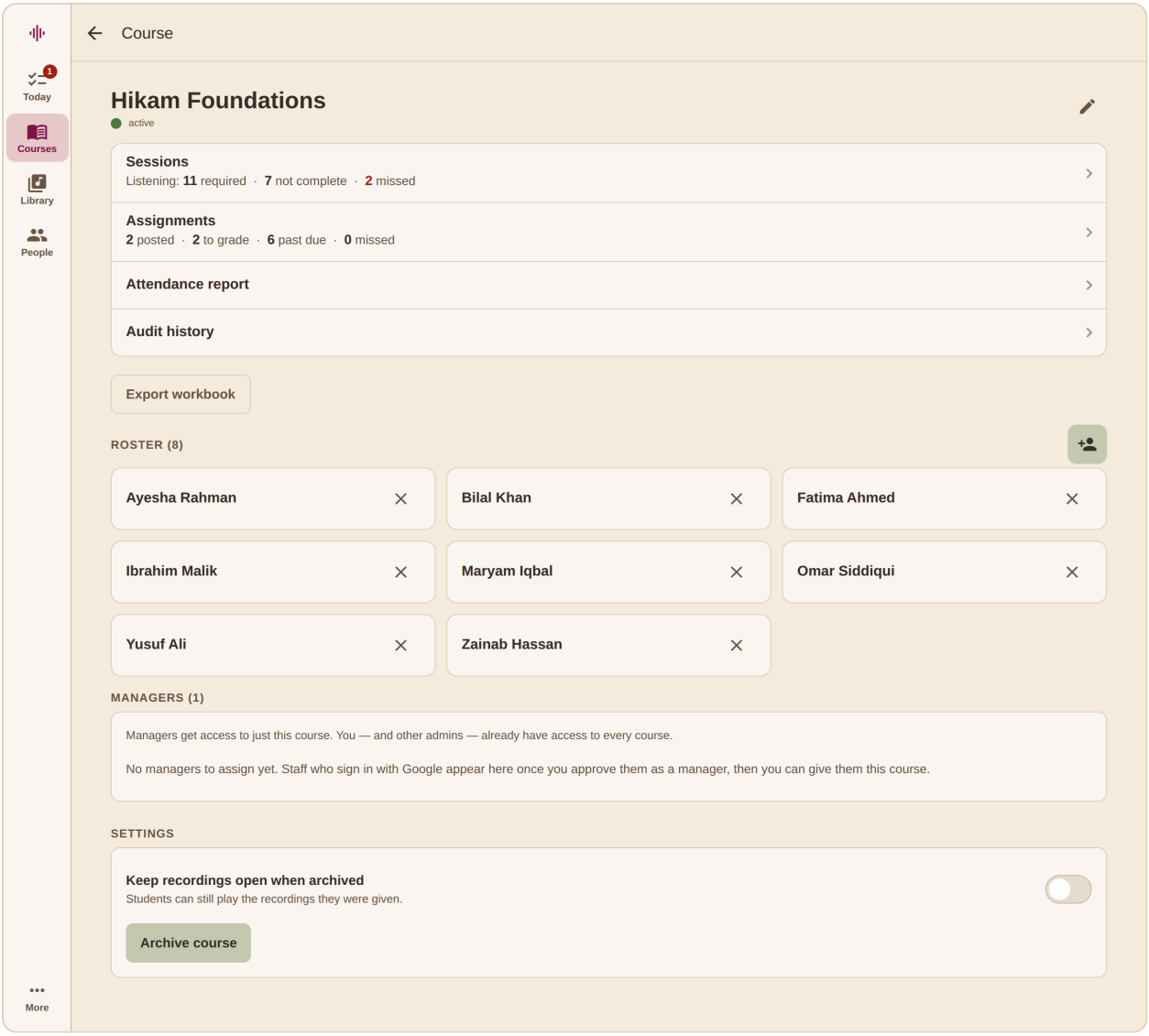


On a computer

The **course page** is your dashboard for that course:


Course
Hikam Foundations
active
Sessions
Listening: 11 required · 7 not complete · 2 missed
Assignments
2 posted · 2 to grade · 6 past due · 0 missed
Attendance report
Audit history
Export workbook
ROSTER (8)
Ayesha Rahman
Bilal Khan
Fatima Ahmed
Ibrahim Malik
Maryam Iqbal
Omar Siddiqui
Yusuf Ali
Zainab Hassan
MANAGERS (1)
Managers get access to just this course. You — and other admins — already have access to every course.
No managers to assign yet. Staff who sign in with Google appear here once you approve them as a manager, then you can give them this course.
SETTINGS
Keep recordings open when archived
Students can still play the recordings they were given.
Archive course
Today
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

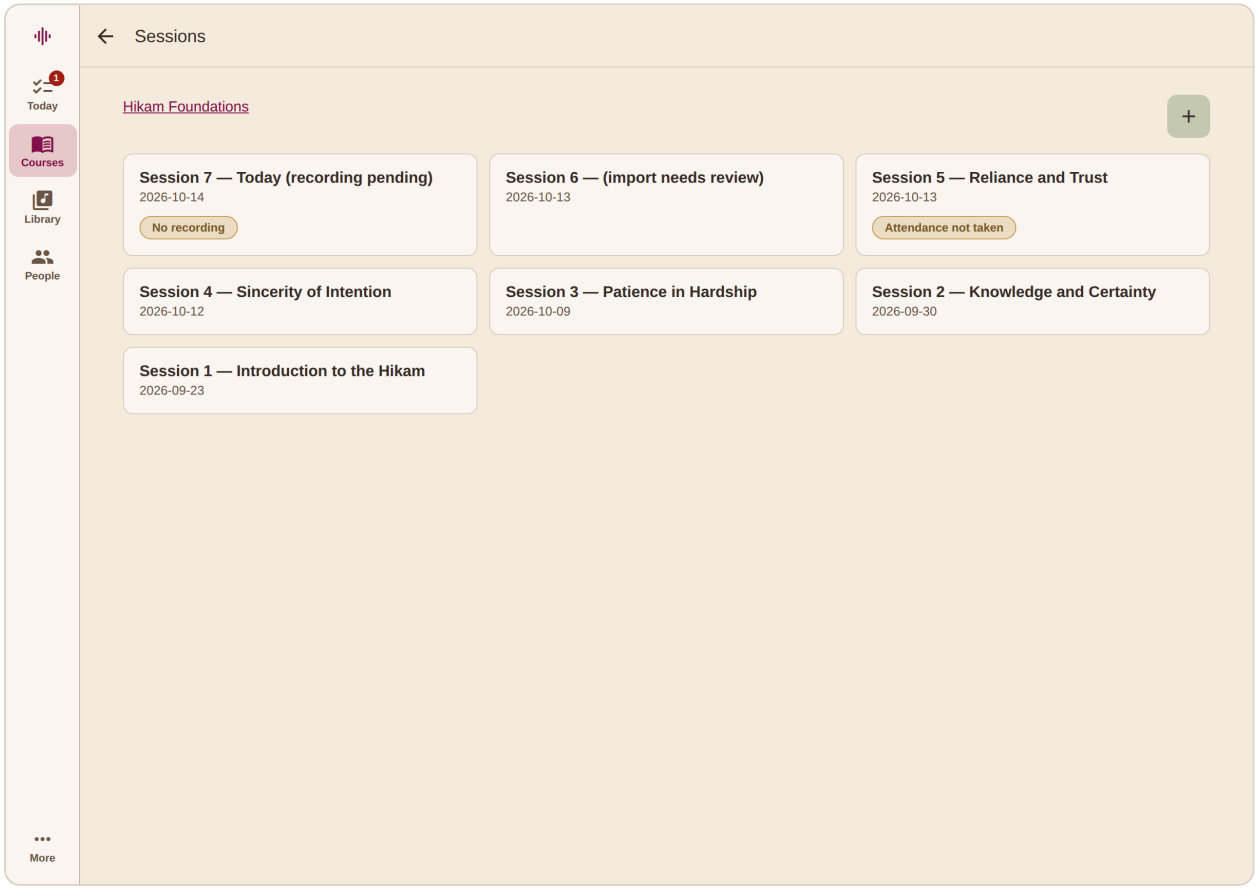
- **Sessions**, **Assignments**, **Attendance report** and **Audit history** are rows at the top, each opening that part of the course: the meetings, where attendance and recordings live (Section 2.4); the assignments, written and posted (Section 2.14), graded and returned (Section 2.15); attendance and catch-up across the whole course (Section 2.9); and the course's history. **Sessions** carries the course's listening at a glance — *N required · not complete · missed* — and **Assignments** counts what is posted, waiting to be graded, past due and missed.
- **Export workbook**, under them, downloads the whole course — every student, session, register and required recording — as one Excel file (Section 2.13).
- **Roster** lists the enrolled students, one line each. Tap a student to see their personal ledger for the course (Section 2.8). The + on its heading adds students: it lists everyone not in the course, and stays open while you add several. The grey × on a row takes that student off the course, after asking — their history is kept, and you can add them back.

- **Managers** (admins) lists the staff assigned to *this* course. Managers only ever see and act on the courses they're assigned to here — being in a cohort grants nothing by itself.
- **Settings** (admins), at the bottom: **Keep recordings open when archived** decides whether an archived course's recordings stay open to the students they were required of, and **Archive course** ends the term. The **pencil** beside the course's name renames it. A manager's own course page has neither Managers nor Settings.

2.4 Sessions, attendance, and adding a recording



On a phone



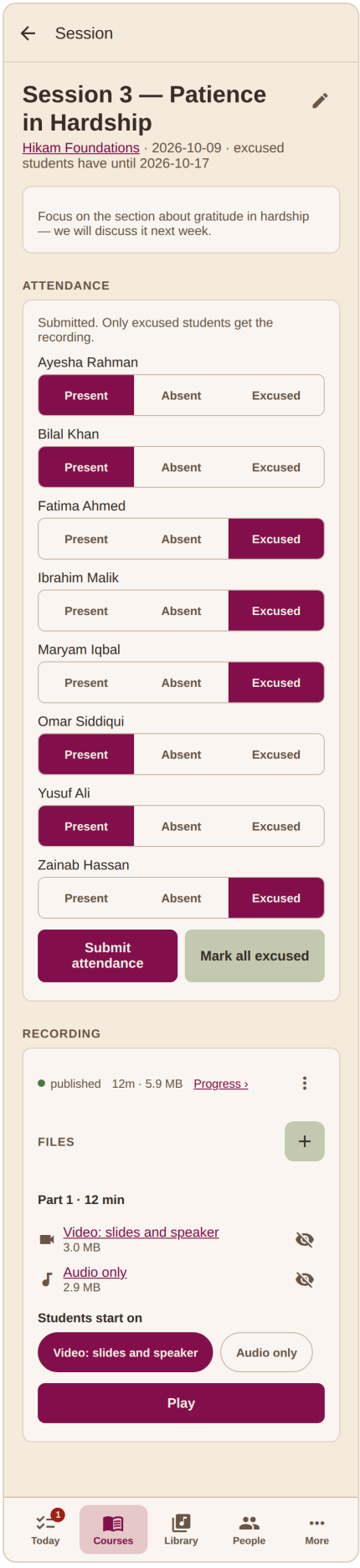
On a computer

A **session** is one class meeting. Create one for each meeting with the + — give it a title, its date, and a **Due by** date. Each session's row says what is still outstanding — **Attendance not taken**, **No recording** — and nothing once it is done.

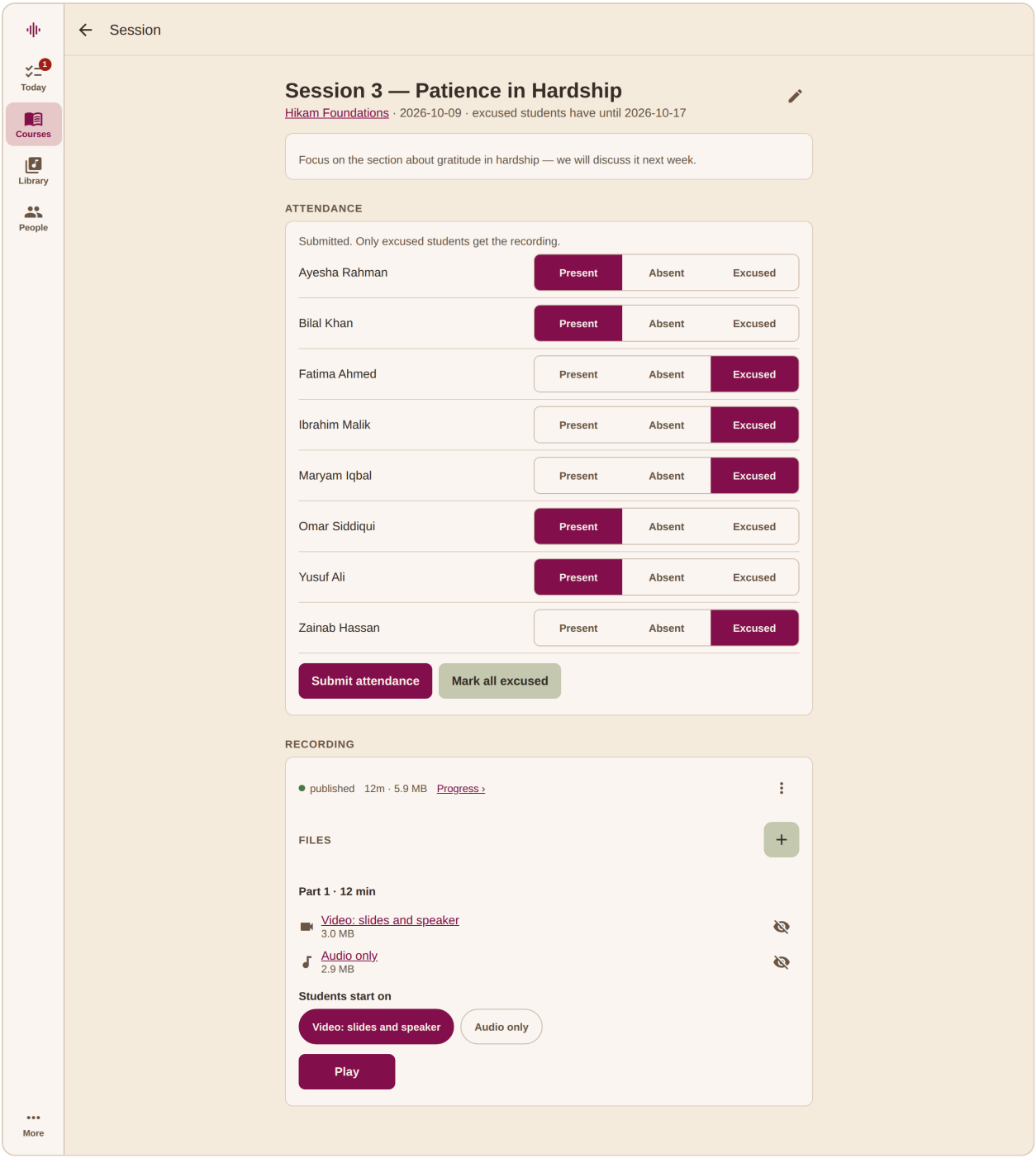
The "Due by" date is required, and it matters more than it looks. It is the day the recording *closes* to the students you excused — after it, they can no longer play it. It fills in automatically as a week after the meeting (or today, if the meeting was long enough ago that a week later has already been and gone); change it to whatever suits. You can't *move* it into the past, and you can move it forward later to reopen a session for someone who needs longer. Everything else about a closed session stays editable — fix a title or a date on a session whose due date has passed and the date simply stays as it is.

The **course name under the heading is a link** — on the sessions list, on a session, and on the attendance report. Tap it to go straight back to the course. The back arrow takes you one step back the way you came; this takes you to the course itself, however many steps in you are, and it works even when you have opened a session from a link somebody sent you.

Open a session to work with it:


Session
Session 3 — Patience in Hardship
Hikam Foundations · 2026-10-09 · excused students have until 2026-10-17
Focus on the section about gratitude in hardship — we will discuss it next week.
ATTENDANCE
Submitted. Only excused students get the recording.
Ayesha Rahman
Present
Absent
Excused
Bilal Khan
Present
Absent
Excused
Fatima Ahmed
Present
Absent
Excused
Ibrahim Malik
Present
Absent
Excused
Maryam Iqbal
Present
Absent
Excused
Omar Siddiqui
Present
Absent
Excused
Yusuf Ali
Present
Absent
Excused
Zainab Hassan
Present
Absent
Excused
Submit attendance
Mark all excused
RECORDING
published 12m · 5.9 MB Progress ›
FILES
Part 1 · 12 min
Video: slides and speaker
3.0 MB
Audio only
2.9 MB
Students start on
Video: slides and speaker
Audio only
Play
Today
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

Take attendance. For each enrolled student, choose **Present**, **Absent**, or **Excused**, then tap **Submit attendance**. Everyone starts as *Present*, so often you only flip the few who missed. You can re-submit a corrected attendance later and everything updates automatically.

Excusing a student is what gives them the recording. It is the only mark that does:

- **Present** — they were there. Nothing is required of them, and the recording is not opened to them.

- **Excused** — they missed it with your permission. The recording opens to them and playing it is required, until the due date.
- **Absent** — they missed it without being excused. Nothing is opened to them.

So **Mark all excused** is the one-tap shortcut for "everyone must catch up on this one." And if someone genuinely needs to catch up on a class you marked them absent for, just change their mark to Excused and submit again.

One limit worth knowing: you can't excuse anyone *new* for a session whose due date has already passed — it would hand them something they could never open. Move the date forward first, then excuse them. Correcting a closed session in every other way still works, including changing someone from excused to present or absent, so the attendance record never becomes uncorrectable.

Add the recording. In the same screen, **Upload files…** from your own computer or phone, or **Import from Zoom**. The recording takes its title, date, and notes from the session, so you don't retype them. Once there is a recording, the **+** beside its **Files** adds more: **Upload files**, or **Add from Zoom** — the second half of a class in another meeting, say.

Editing the session. The **pencil** at the top opens its title, date, **Due by** date and notes. An admin deletes a session from there too, once it has no recording.

Importing from Zoom. Every class in a cohort is held in the same recurring Zoom meeting, so every recording in the list has the same title. What tells them apart is when it ran: each card shows the date and the hours, for example *2026-10-08 · 6:02–8:18 PM*, so the 6 pm and 7 pm classes of one evening are two different cards. The list opens showing only recordings from the session's own date. Untick **Only recordings from this session's date** to choose a date range and load it. Dates and hours are institute time (America/Chicago), so an evening class is listed under the day it was held.

Zoom keeps several files of one meeting, and each card lists them all: **Video: slides and speaker**, **Video: slides only**, **Audio only**, each with its size. If the meeting was stopped and restarted, its files come in **stretches** — *Stretch 1*, *Stretch 2* — each with its own hours; each stretch you import becomes one **part** of the recording, in order. Tick the files you want, or use a **quick pick** on the card — **Audio only**, **Video and audio**, or **Everything** — which ticks those files in every stretch at once. A file Zoom is still processing cannot be ticked until it is ready. **Filters** — the sliders

beside the search — show recordings already imported too, narrow the list to one kind of file, or bring back recordings under two minutes; a line under the search says when they are doing any of that.

Under the list, **Selected** adds it all up before anything is copied: how many files, their size, how much class they cover, and roughly what they will cost to store each month. **Video is where that cost is** — a two-hour class is tens of megabytes as audio and a gigabyte or more as video — so import video when the class needs it (slides, a whiteboard), and audio only when it doesn't. Tap **Import N files** and you're taken back to the session; the files copy from Zoom on their own, usually in under a minute, and the session shows each one as *copying from Zoom…* until it arrives. A file already imported is marked so, with a link to where it went, and can't be imported twice.

The recording's files. On the session, each recording lists its parts in order and, under each part, its versions, with their size or state:

- **The file's name** is a link that plays it, so you can check it.
- **The eye** hides a file from students without deleting it, and tapped again puts it back — for example a slides-only version nobody needs. A published recording must keep at least one file students can play.
- **The red bin** deletes a file, so a bad one can be replaced. A file students can play is removed only from a draft; once a recording has been published its files are hidden, not removed.
- **The arrows** on a part's line fix the order if the parts came in wrong.
- **Students start on** chooses which version the player opens on when there is more than one — students can switch at any time.

Above the files, one line gives the recording's status, its length and size, and **Progress ›** (Section 2.6). The ⋮ at its end holds the moves that take it away from students or back to work on — **Archive**, **Unpublish**, **Back to draft** — and **Delete**, for an admin, or **Discard** for an empty draft. **Publish** and **Play** are the buttons under the files.

If a copy from Zoom fails, the file says why and **Retry import** tries again.

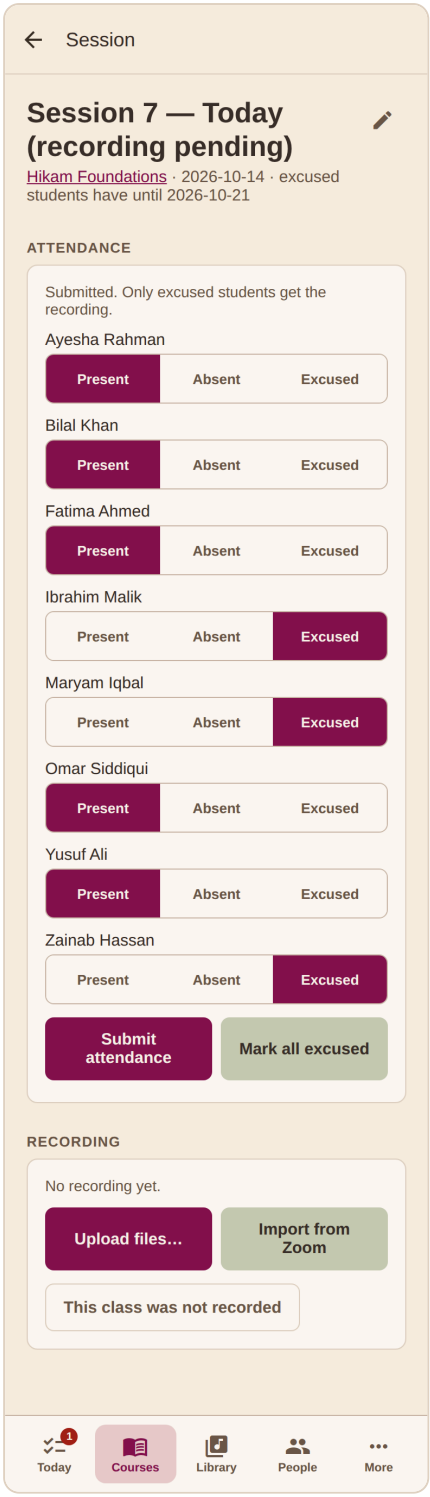
Uploading files. Upload files… takes one file or several at once: audio as M4A, MP3 or WAV (up to 300 MB each), and video as MP4 (up to 8 GB each). The chosen files are listed before anything is sent. Each one becomes a new part, in the order listed, unless you tap **Version of Part**

N to make it another version of a part already there — for example a phone video of the whiteboard beside the Zoom audio. A part takes one uploaded video and one audio file. Then tap **Upload N files**.

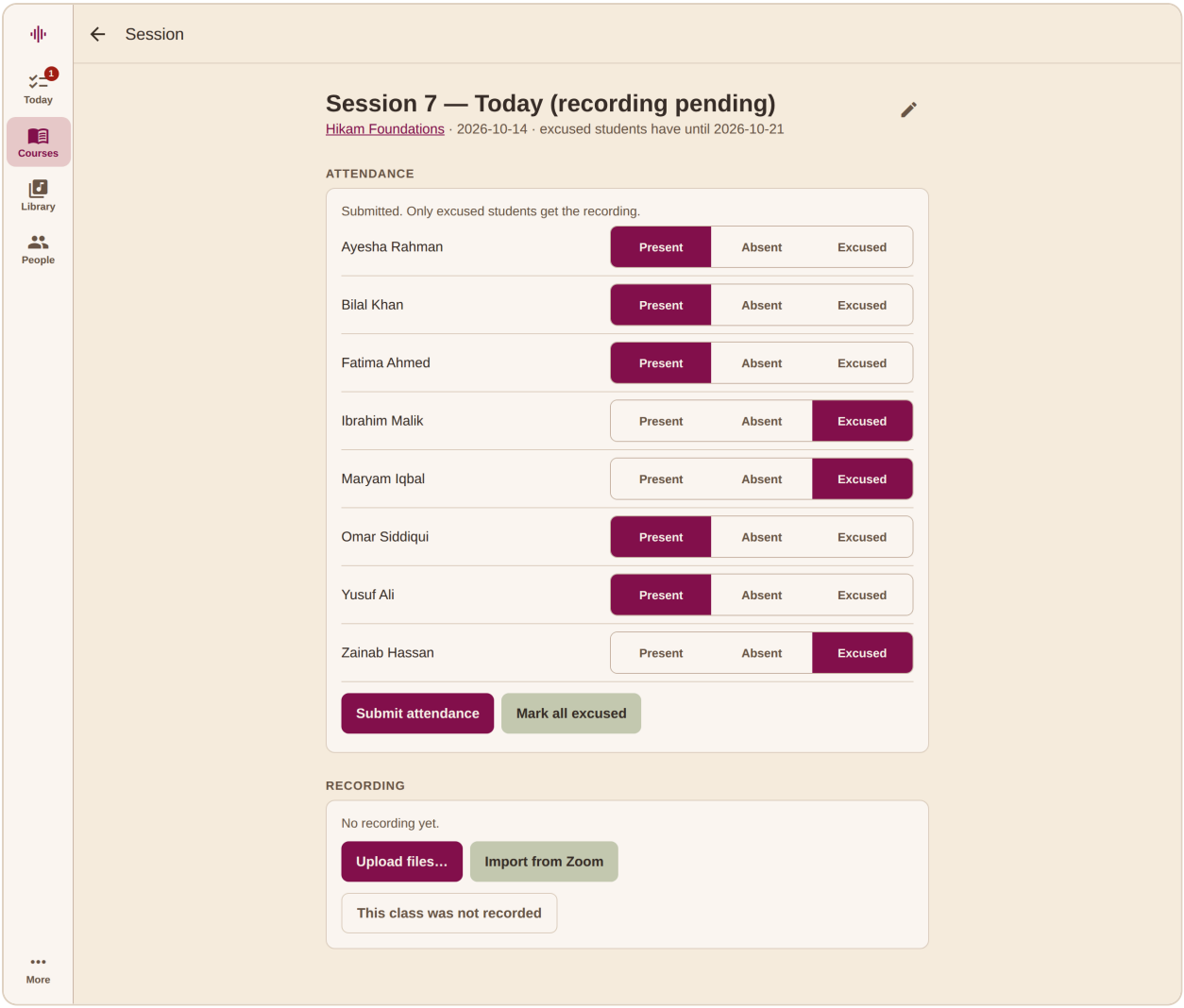
Each file shows how far it has got. Big files go up in pieces, so a dropped connection costs a few seconds, not the whole upload. When a file has arrived the app checks that phones can play it. A video in another format — an iPhone's HEVC video is the usual one — is refused with what to do instead: export it as MP4 (H.264) and upload that. Files can be added to a published recording too; students see a new one only once it has arrived.

Stay on the page until the files say Added. Leaving it, or tapping **Stop uploading**, stops the upload and keeps nothing of the unfinished file. A file that is still uploading, or that failed, can be taken off with its **bin** at any time, even on a published recording, since no student ever saw it.

Or say it wasn't recorded. Some classes aren't, and until you say so the app keeps asking: **Today** shows the session as waiting for its recording, and you get the "attendance still not taken" reminder every morning. **This class was not recorded** stops both. It changes nothing else — the register stays exactly as it is, and the marks in it still count — and **It was recorded after all** puts the session back if you change your mind.


Session
Session 7 — Today (recording pending)
Hikam Foundations · 2026-10-14 · excused students have until 2026-10-21
ATTENDANCE
Submitted. Only excused students get the recording.
Ayesha Rahman
Present
Absent
Excused
Bilal Khan
Present
Absent
Excused
Fatima Ahmed
Present
Absent
Excused
Ibrahim Malik
Present
Absent
Excused
Maryam Iqbal
Present
Absent
Excused
Omar Siddiqui
Present
Absent
Excused
Yusuf Ali
Present
Absent
Excused
Zainab Hassan
Present
Absent
Excused
Submit attendance
Mark all excused
RECORDING
No recording yet.
Upload files…
Import from Zoom
This class was not recorded
Today
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

Each recording moves through a few states:

- **Draft** — added, not yet visible to students. You can add, remove and replace its files freely.
- **Published** — live. The students you excused can now play it, and are on the hook for it. Publishing needs at least one file students can play and nothing still copying or failed, and it is blocked if the session's due date has already passed, because nobody would be able to open it.
- **Needs attention** — flagged for a problem (for example, a Zoom import that needs review). Publish is blocked until it has a file students can play.
- **Unpublished** — pulled back from students after being live. It goes back to Draft to be fixed, then out again.
- **Archived** — closed for good, one recording at a time. Like unpublishing, it closes the recording to everyone who was excused, so **Today** raises it if you archive one whose due date has not passed yet. One tap puts it back — while that date is still ahead. Once it has passed,

Publish is greyed out and the card says why: publishing then would give nobody access, so move the session's **Due by** date forward first, which reopens it for everyone excused.

Archiving or unpublishing a recording takes it out of the course totals. Everything that happened on it — who completed it, who missed it — leaves the course page's counts, the attendance report's catch-up columns and each student's per-course counts, as if it had never been required. The recording's own **Progress** page still keeps its rows (Section 2.8), but nothing sums it into the term. So this is not how a term ends: **to close a term, archive the course** (Section 2.3), which keeps every count and only decides whether its recordings stay open. Reach for archiving a recording only when that recording itself should be withdrawn.

2.5 How a recording becomes required

Here's the rule that runs the whole ledger:

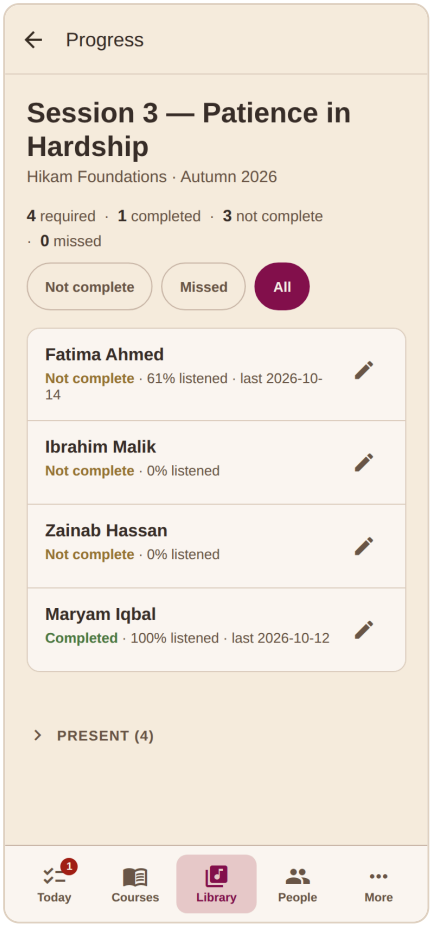
> **A recording opens to the students marked EXCUSED for its session, and to nobody else** — automatically, once the recording is **published** and its attendance has been **submitted**. The same fact makes it required. It closes again when the session's **Due by** date passes.

You never give students a recording one by one; the attendance sheet decides who gets it. If you correct attendance — flip someone from excused to present, or the reverse — access and obligations update to match, and any progress or completion already recorded is kept.

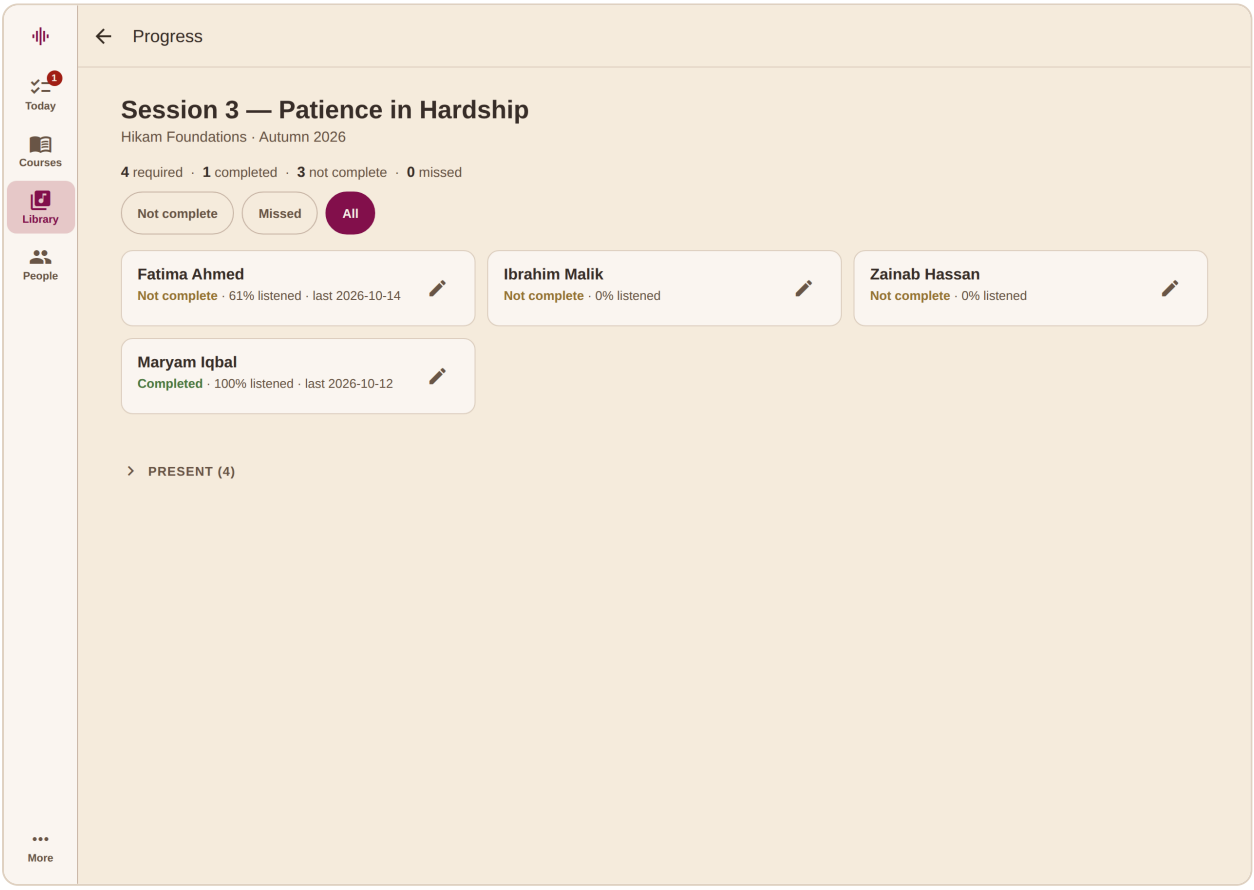
- **Being enrolled opens no recording.** A student in the class who was present, or absent without being excused, cannot play the recording at all. (Enrolment does give a student the course's assignments — Section 2.14.)
- **The due date closes it.** After that day the student sees the recording on their list marked *Missed*, with the date it closed, and can no longer play it. Move the session's Due by date forward to reopen it. Students see the date as **Watch by** on a recording with video and **Listen by** on one that is audio only.
- **A student who joins late** wasn't on the roster when earlier attendance was taken, so they are **not** retroactively given those older sessions. On an earlier session's register they appear as *not marked* — correcting somebody else's mark there leaves them that way. If you *do* want a latecomer to catch up on an earlier one, open that session, mark them **Excused**, and re-submit attendance.

- **Unpublishing** a recording closes it to everyone again.

2.6 The recording ledger — who has caught up



On a phone



On a computer

Open a recording's **Progress** (from its session, or from the library) to see exactly where things stand. Up top, one line of counts: **required** (the students you excused, the only ones who can open it), **completed**, **not complete**, and **missed**. An archived or unpublished recording keeps this page: the counts and rows are the record as it stood when it closed, and a grant that was still open then reads *Closed (recording archived)*. It is the only place that record survives — the course totals no longer include it (Section 2.6).

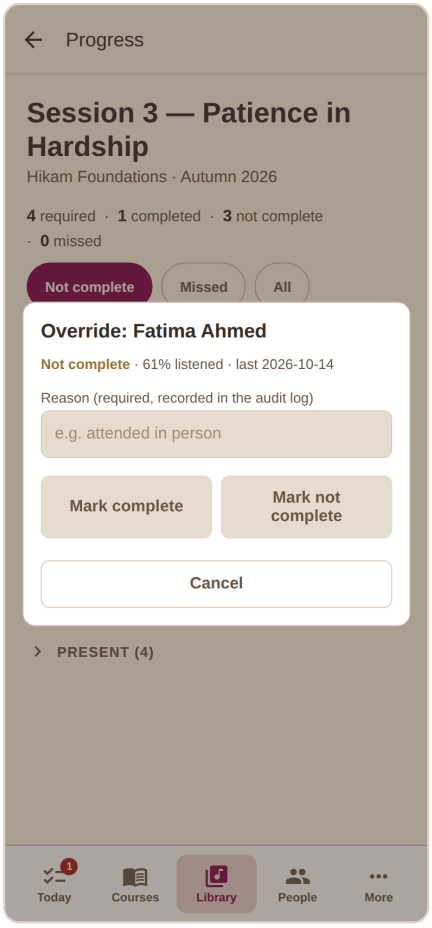
The required list comes first — the students you excused, each with their status (**Completed**, **Not complete** or **Missed**), how much they've played and when they last played it. The **filter chips** — *Not complete / Missed / All* — open on **Not complete**, so you land on exactly the people who still need a nudge.

Below it, closed sections hold everyone else, each with its count — tap one to open it:

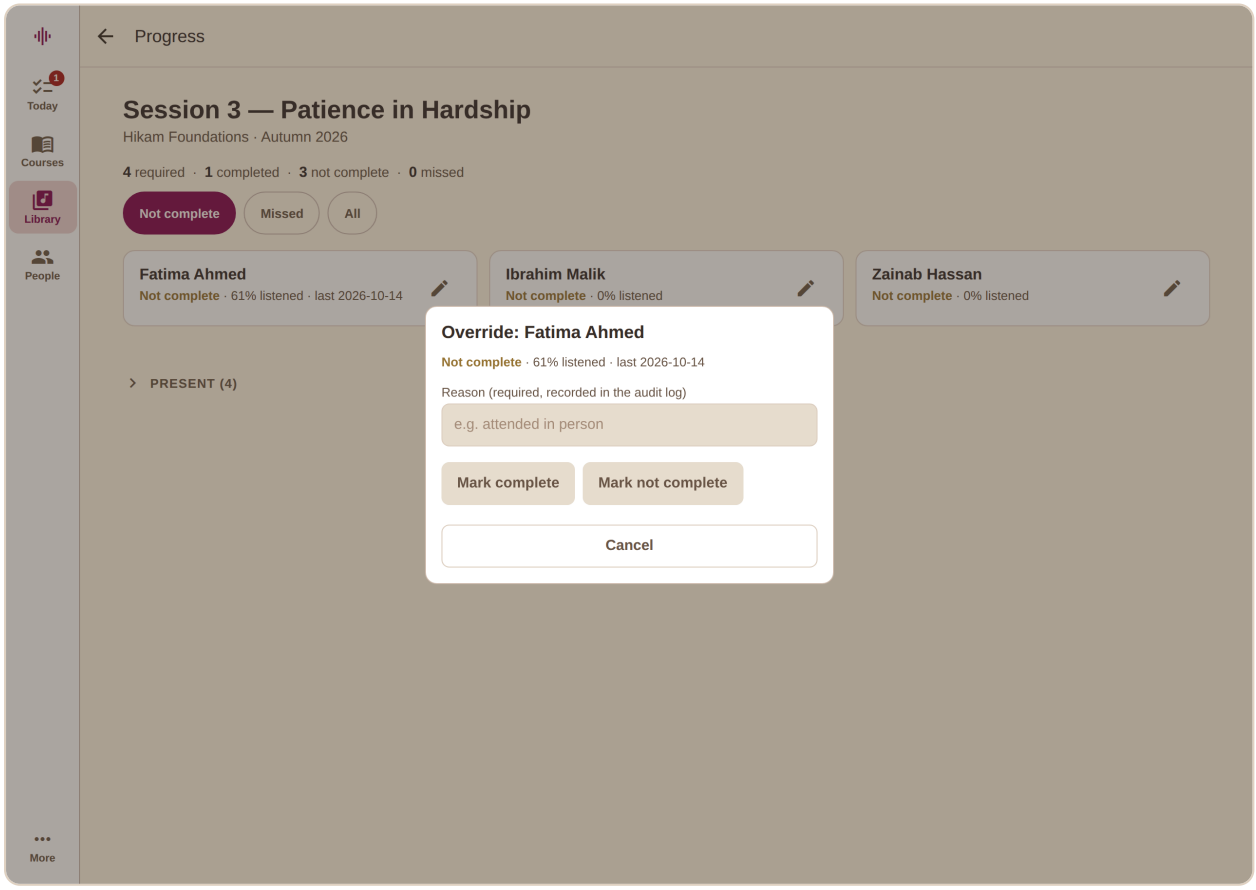
- **Present** — the students who were there. The recording is neither required for them nor open to them.
- **Absent** — marked absent rather than excused, so it was never opened to them. To let one of them catch up, mark them **Excused** on the session and submit again.
- **Excused, access closed** — students you excused whose access has since been withdrawn: they were unenrolled from the class, or the recording was unpublished or archived. Nothing is required of them and they can't open it. Re-enrolling them, or publishing the recording again, restores it — for anything still inside its due date. A session whose date has already passed stays closed, so nobody comes back to an obligation they had no chance to meet.
- **Also listened** — progress from someone who no longer holds the recording, for example a student you excused, who played it, and whom you then corrected to present. Kept as history.

For a copy you can keep or hand on, export the course's **workbook** from the course page (Section 2.13); its **Detail** tab is this ledger for every recording in the course.

2.7 Overriding a completion



On a phone



On a computer

Sometimes the ledger and reality differ — a student caught up in person, or played it on someone else's device. Tap the **pencil** on their row to set the status yourself:

- Enter a **reason** — it's **required**, and it's written into the audit history so there's always a record of why. "Caught up with the teacher one-on-one" is a good example.
- Choose **Mark complete** or **Mark not complete**.

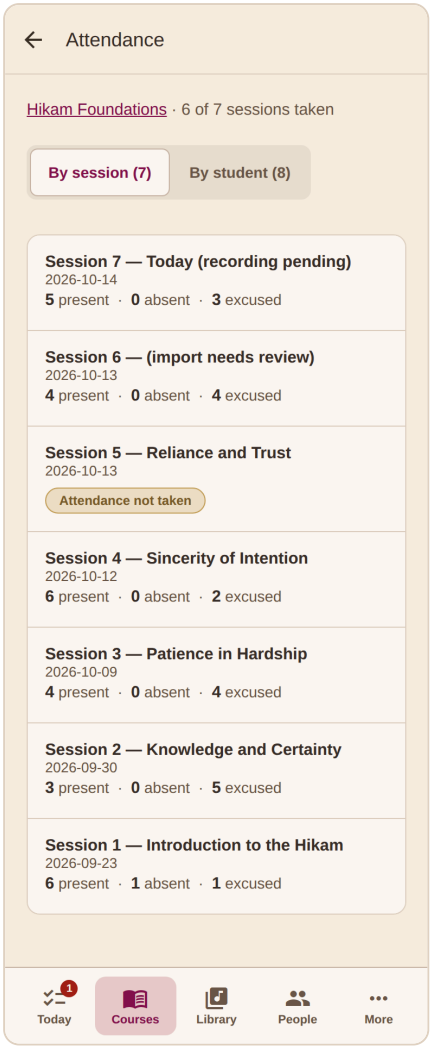
An override **wins over the student's own mark**. If you mark someone complete and they later fiddle with their own status, your override stands. To undo it, tap the pencil again and **Remove override** — the status falls back to whatever the student's own mark says. Every override, and every removal, is audited.

The student sees it too, with the reason you typed — on their player, in their list, and in what the app counts as outstanding. Somebody you have marked complete stops being asked to catch up and stops getting the last-day reminder, and they cannot unmark what you set. Write the reason for them as much as for the record: "Caught up with the teacher one-on-one" is read by the person it is about.

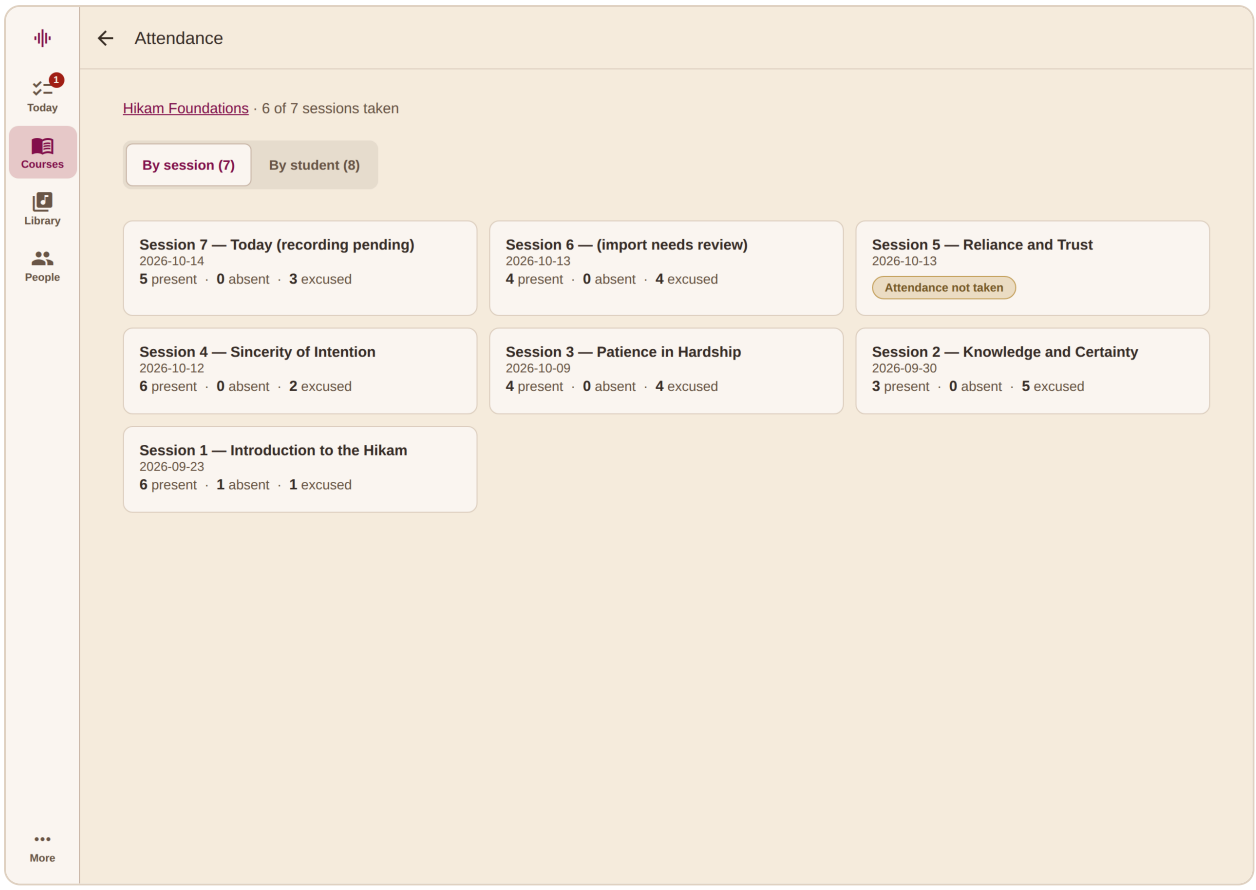
2.8 One student's ledger

From a course's **Roster**, tap a student to see *their* view: the recordings they're required to play in that course, each with its status, and the same action-first filters. It's the per-person counterpart to the per-recording ledger in 2.6 — the right screen when a parent or student asks "where do I stand?" Tap the student's **name** at the top to open their profile — the same page People opens — for their access, every course they are in, and their history.

2.9 The attendance report



On a phone



On a computer

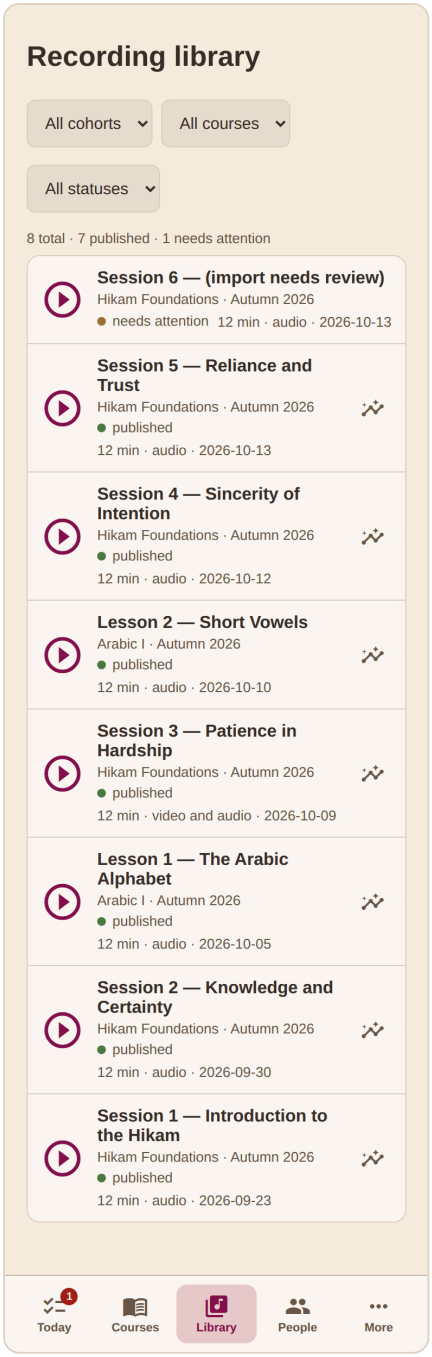
Reached from the course page, the **attendance report** rolls the whole course up two ways — a toggle switches between them:

- **By session** — every session with its present / absent / excused counts, and a clear flag on any meeting where attendance was never taken.
- **By student** — each student's attendance across the course (chronic absentees first), plus their **catch-up** status: of the recordings they were excused from, how many are complete and how many they missed.

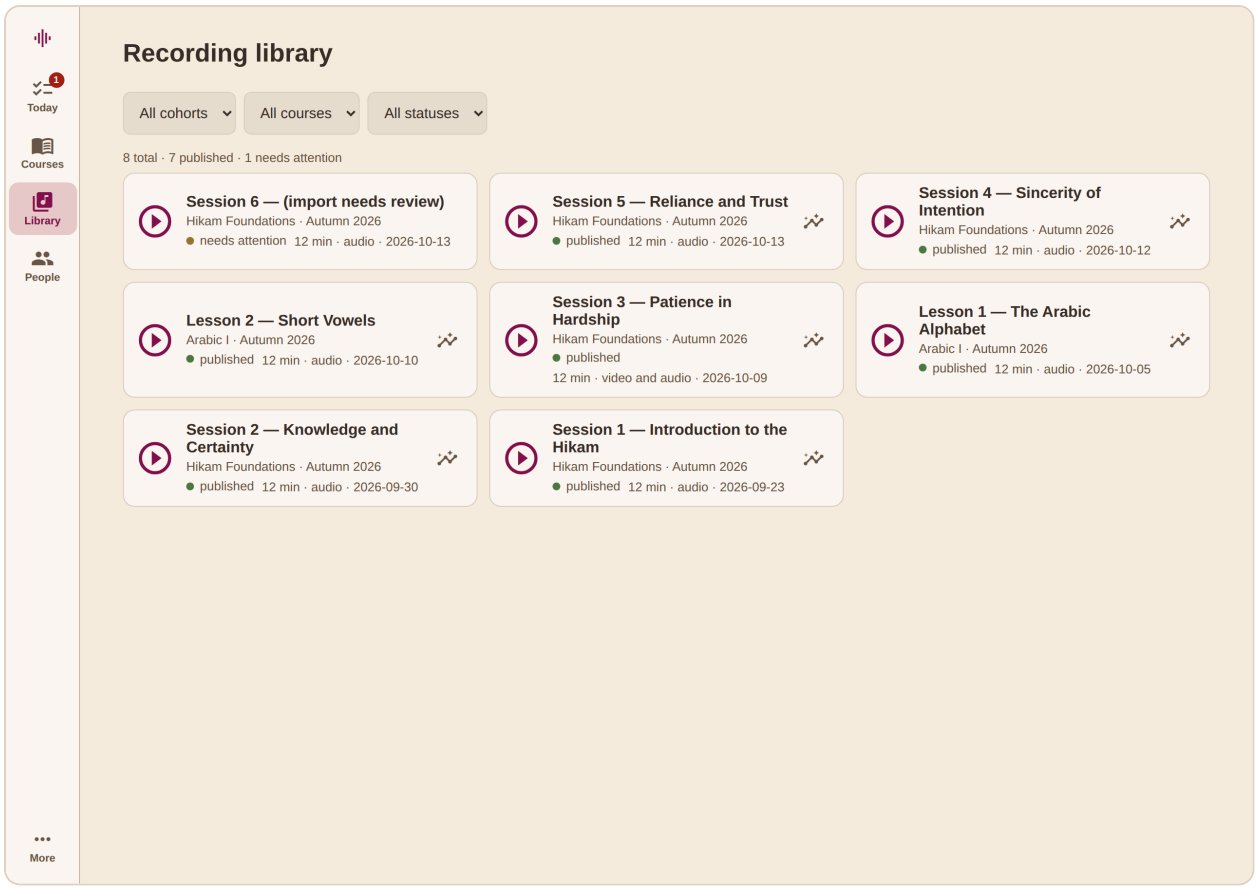
The course **workbook** (Section 2.13) carries the same numbers in a form you can keep: the **Students** and **Sessions** tabs are these two views, and the **Register** tab is the roster with every mark.

Tap any row to go straight to the detail. A session opens that session — its attendance roster and its recording; a student opens that student's progress for the course. So the report is where you spot the problem, and one tap is where you deal with it.

2.10 The recording library



On a phone

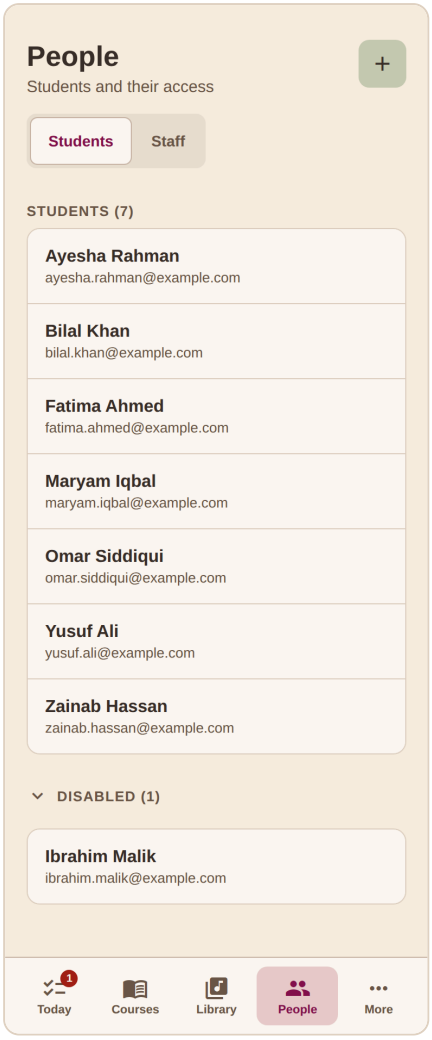


On a computer

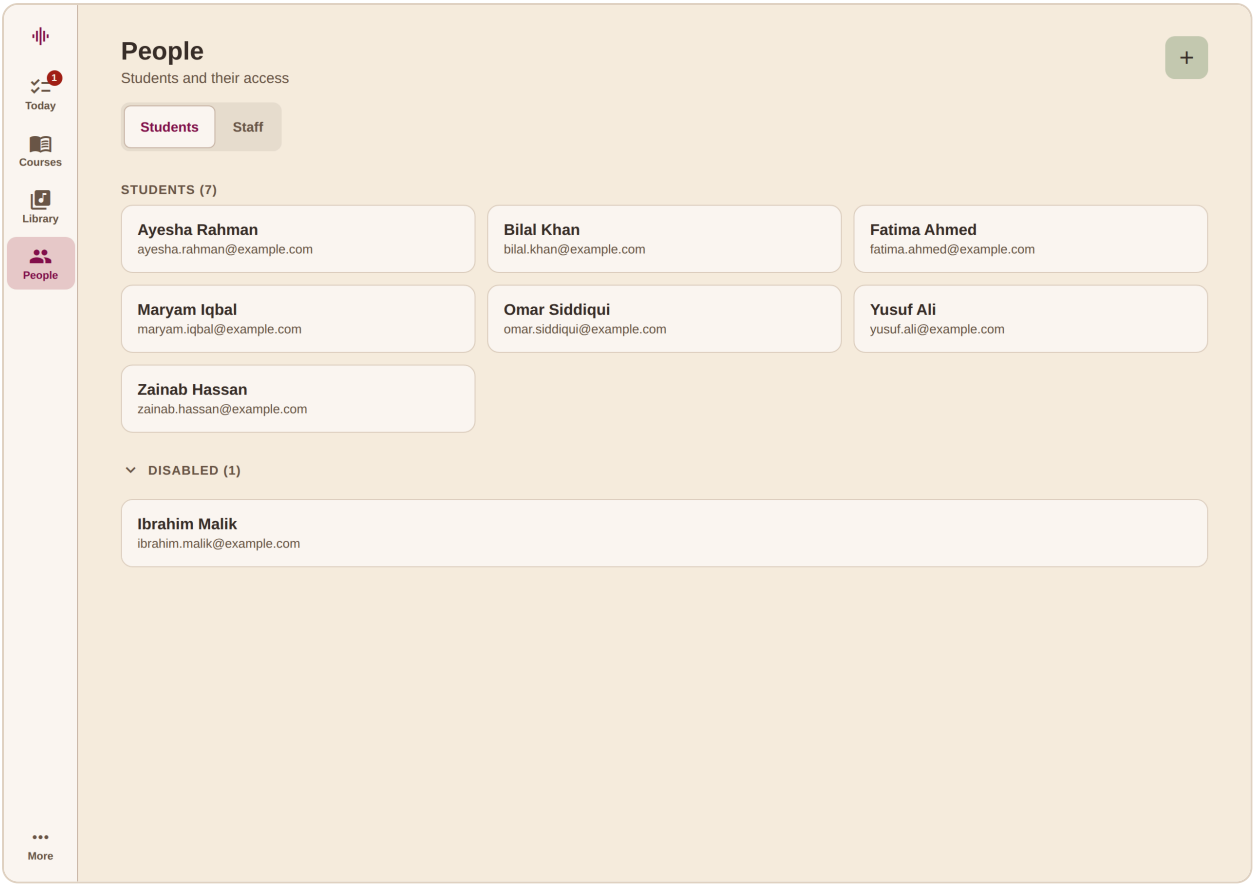
The **library** is every recording you can see, across all your courses, in one list with a count summary. It's the fastest way to answer "which recordings still need their files?" or "what's flagged?" without walking course by course. Admins see everything; managers see their assigned courses. Each row starts with a large play button: **tap the row to play it**, and the small chart at its end to see its **Progress**.

Three dropdowns narrow the list. Choose a **cohort** and leave the course alone to see everything in that term; choose a **course** as well to see just that course. The course list offers the courses in the cohort you chose — or every course, each with its term, when no cohort is chosen — and the count line describes whatever you have narrowed to. **Status** narrows to published, draft, archived, unpublished or needs attention. The × after them appears whenever something is narrowing the list and puts everything back.

2.11 People — managing students



On a phone



On a computer

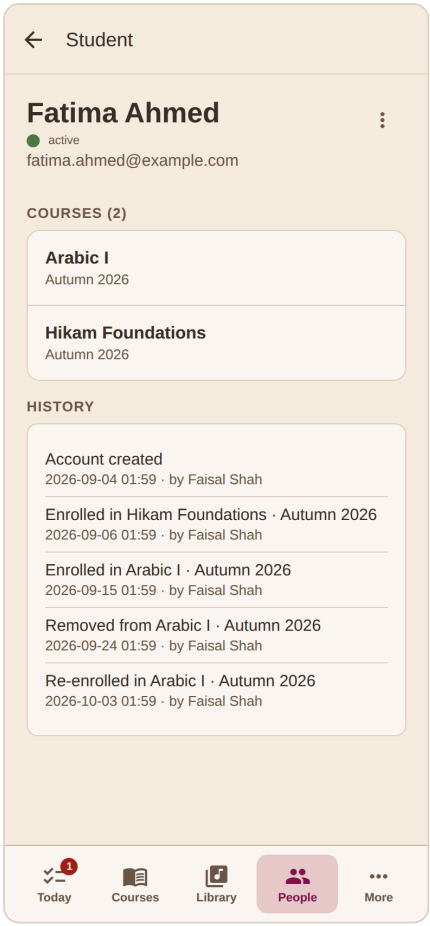
People holds both populations. Admins get a **Students / Staff** switch above the list; managers see the student directory and no switch, because approving staff isn't theirs to do. The directory is the whole institute for every staff member — a manager can look someone up before enrolling them, which they could not do if the list were cut to the courses they already run. What a manager cannot see is anyone's *progress* outside their own courses: open a student and the page shows only the courses that manager runs.

To add a student, tap the **+**, enter their **full name** and **email**, optionally **enrol them in a course** right away, and tap **Create account**. The app emails them a link to set their own password — you never handle passwords. The course list offers only courses that are running; an archived course, or one in an archived cohort, is not listed there (you can still enrol someone into it from the course's own page).

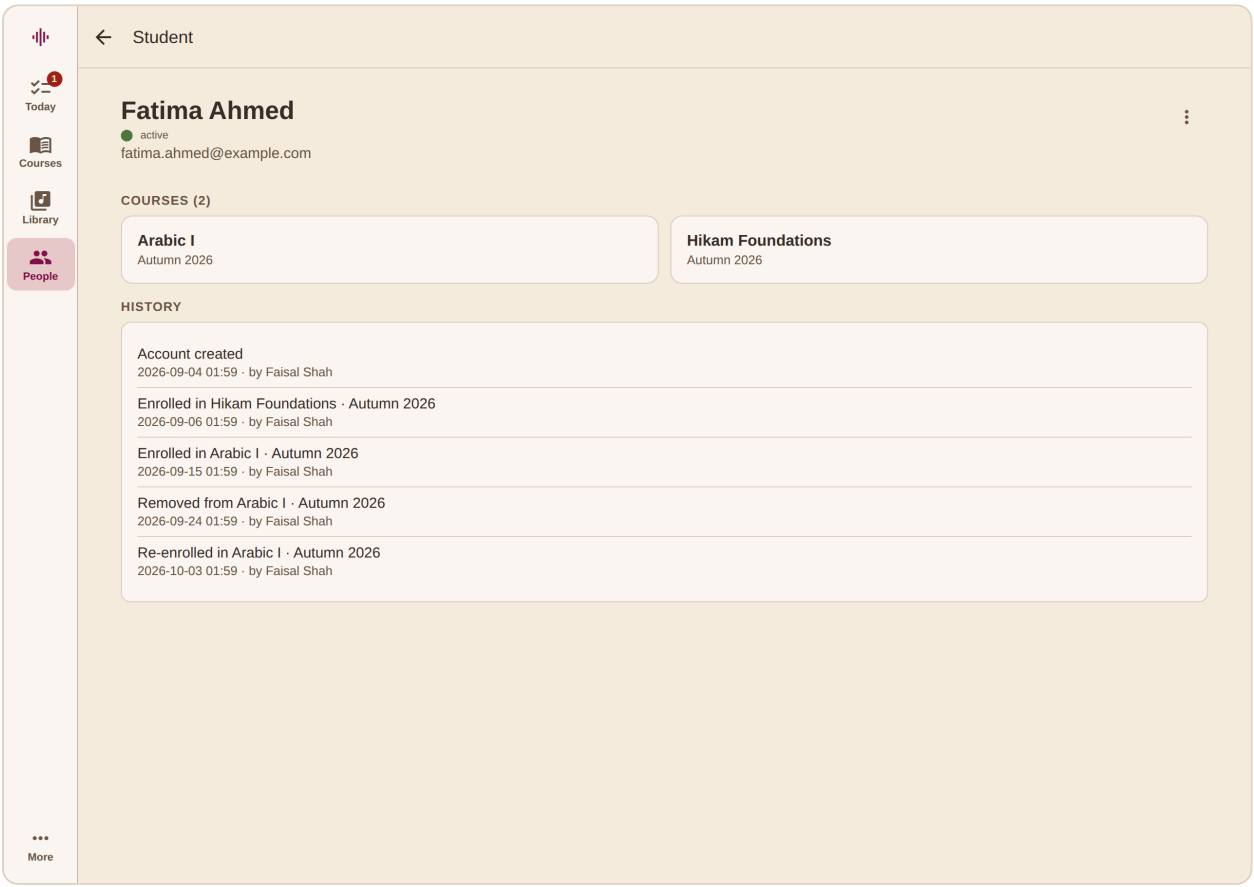
Creating accounts is done on the website, not in the phone apps. The **+** in the figures above is a capture of the website at a phone's width; in the Android app it is simply absent. This is a store requirement rather than a limitation we chose, and it only affects *creating* — changing roles, disabling an account and enrolling someone all work everywhere.

The list itself is just for finding someone. **Tap a student to open their page**, where everything about them lives. Students you've disabled move out of the main list into a **Disabled** section at the bottom — tap the heading to open it.

A student’s page



On a phone



On a computer

It shows their name, address and whether they're **active** or **disabled**. The ⋮ beside the name holds what can be done:

- **Resend password link** — if they lost the email or the link expired.
- **Export workbook** — one Excel file for this student across their courses (Section 2.13).
- **Disable account** — turns off access without deleting anything. (Disable, don't delete — deletion is a separate, deliberate, admin-only step.) Admins only; a manager's menu does not have it, because access spans every course.

Below that are **the courses they're in**. Tap one to open that student's progress for it.

If you're a **manager**, this lists the courses *you* manage — it's headed **Courses you manage** to say so. You aren't shown classes you don't run, so treat it as your view of the student rather than their whole record. An admin sees every course.

History, at the bottom, is the student's record from the day the account was created: when it was made and by whom, then every enrolment, removal and return, and every time the account was disabled or re-enabled — each with who did it and when, in the institute's time. It is read from the same audit history admins see (Section 3.3), so nothing here is a second record. A manager's list covers the courses they manage; account changes are admin-only, and an admin sees everything.

2.12 Notifications *(staff)*

Tap **More**, then **Notifications**. Managers get one message — and only one, deliberately: students are told about assignments, but a teacher is not sent a message for every hand-in, since **Today** carries the count.

- **Attendance still not taken** — a couple of days after a class meeting whose attendance you never submitted.

It goes to the people who manage the class, so if you manage none — which is usual for an administrator — you have no switches here, and the screen says so. A session marked **not recorded** stops sending it.

It’s more useful than it sounds. Until attendance is submitted nobody has been excused, so a recording you’ve already published is sitting there that not one student can open. **Today** shows the same thing in the app, with a count on the tab, so this message is a nudge rather than the only warning.

Reaching this device needs its permission as well. The app offers to set that up once, on Today after you sign in; you can also tap **Enable notifications** on this screen at any time. If it says they are blocked, use **Open settings** on a phone, or allow them from the site settings behind the icon in your browser’s address bar.

2.13 Exporting a workbook

Two buttons produce every export the app has, and both make an **Excel workbook** — one `.xlsx` file with several tabs — rather than a flat list. On a phone the file goes to the share sheet, so you can send it to yourself or save it; on a computer it downloads.

Export workbook on a course page covers the whole course:

- **Summary** — the course’s cohort, status and managers, the size of the roster, how many registers have been taken, the attendance and catch-up rates for the class, how many required recordings are still open, and when the file was made and by whom.
- **Students** — one row per student: when they joined and left, their attendance counts and rate, and their catch-up on excused sessions — required, completed, still open, missed deadline, closed. Sorted so the students with the most missed deadlines are at the top. A **Note** column flags registers they were never marked on and completions that came from a staff override.
- **Sessions** — one row per meeting: when its register was taken and the marks on it, the recording’s status, when it was published and its due date, and how the excused students have done with it. A recording that has been archived or unpublished is noted as *withdrawn from the totals*.
- **Register** — students down the side, sessions across the top, one mark in each cell: **P**, **A**, **E**, a dot for a register never taken, a dash for a session outside the time the student was enrolled.
- **Recordings** — the same grid for published recordings: whether each excused student completed it (and when), or is still open, missed the deadline, or was closed — with how much of the recording they have played.

- **Detail** — every required recording as its own row, with played, last played, completed at, and any override with its reason. This is the ledger of Section 2.6 for the whole course; filter it in Excel.
- **Definitions** — what every term in the file means, so the workbook explains itself to whoever you send it to.

Export workbook on a student's page covers one person across courses:

- **Summary** — their account, how many courses they are in, and their attendance and catch-up totals across all of them.
- **Courses** — one row per course, with the same enrolment, attendance and catch-up columns the course workbook gives each student.
- **Sessions** — every meeting in the time they were enrolled, in date order across courses, with their mark and — if excused — the recording's due date and outcome.
- **Recordings** — every recording they were required to play, with the evidence behind it.
- **History** — their record from the day the account was created: enrolments, removals and returns, account changes — each with who did it and when. It is the history the student's page shows (Section 2.11), plus the completion overrides the page leaves to each recording's ledger.
- **Definitions** — as above.

A manager's student workbook covers **the courses they manage**, and its Summary says so on the **Scope** line — the same view of the student their screens give. An admin's covers every course.

The file's **Definitions** tab reads:

Term	Meaning
Held	Registers submitted for sessions between the day the student joined the class and the day they left it, in which they were marked. A session whose register was never taken is not held for anyone.
Present / Absent / Excused	The mark on the register. Excused is the only mark that opens the recording and requires it.
Attendance rate	Present ÷ Held.
Required	Excused sessions whose recording is published — one recording the student must play and mark complete by its due date. A recording that has been archived or unpublished is withdrawn: it counts nowhere, and the Sessions tab says so.
Completed	The student marked the recording complete, or staff overrode it as complete (the override's reason is recorded).
Still open	Not yet completed, and the due date has not passed.
Missed deadline	Not completed by the due date. Access has closed; nothing further can happen to it unless the date is moved.
Closed	A required recording that was withdrawn from the student before its due date: they left the class, or the class was archived with its recordings closed. Neither completed nor missed.
Catch-up rate	Completed ÷ (Completed + Missed deadline). Open and closed items are not held against anyone.
Played	Time played as a share of the recording's length. Evidence, not the gate — completion is the student's own mark.
Times	Institute time (America/Chicago). Dates are real dates; sort and filter them in Excel.

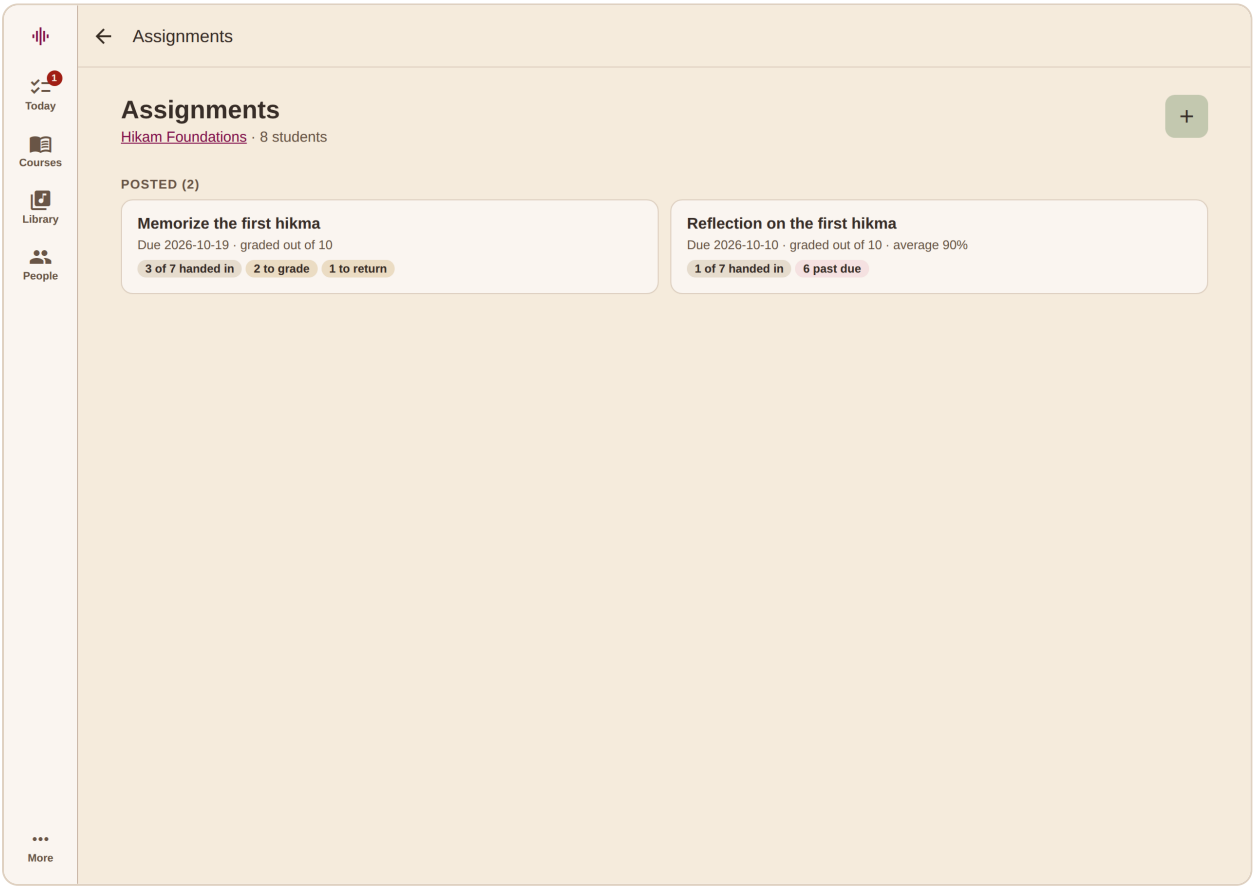
The columns hold real dates and real numbers, not text — so they sort, filter and add up in Excel. A rate shows a dash where there is nothing to divide by.

Assignments and grades are not in the workbooks yet; an assignment's own page (Section 2.15) is the report for it.

2.14 Assignments — writing and posting

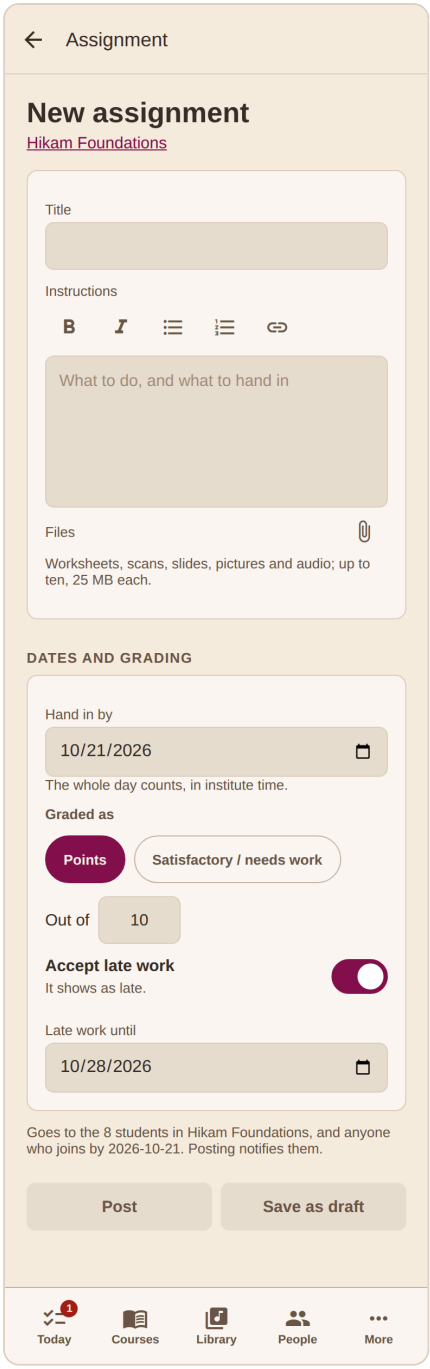


On a phone

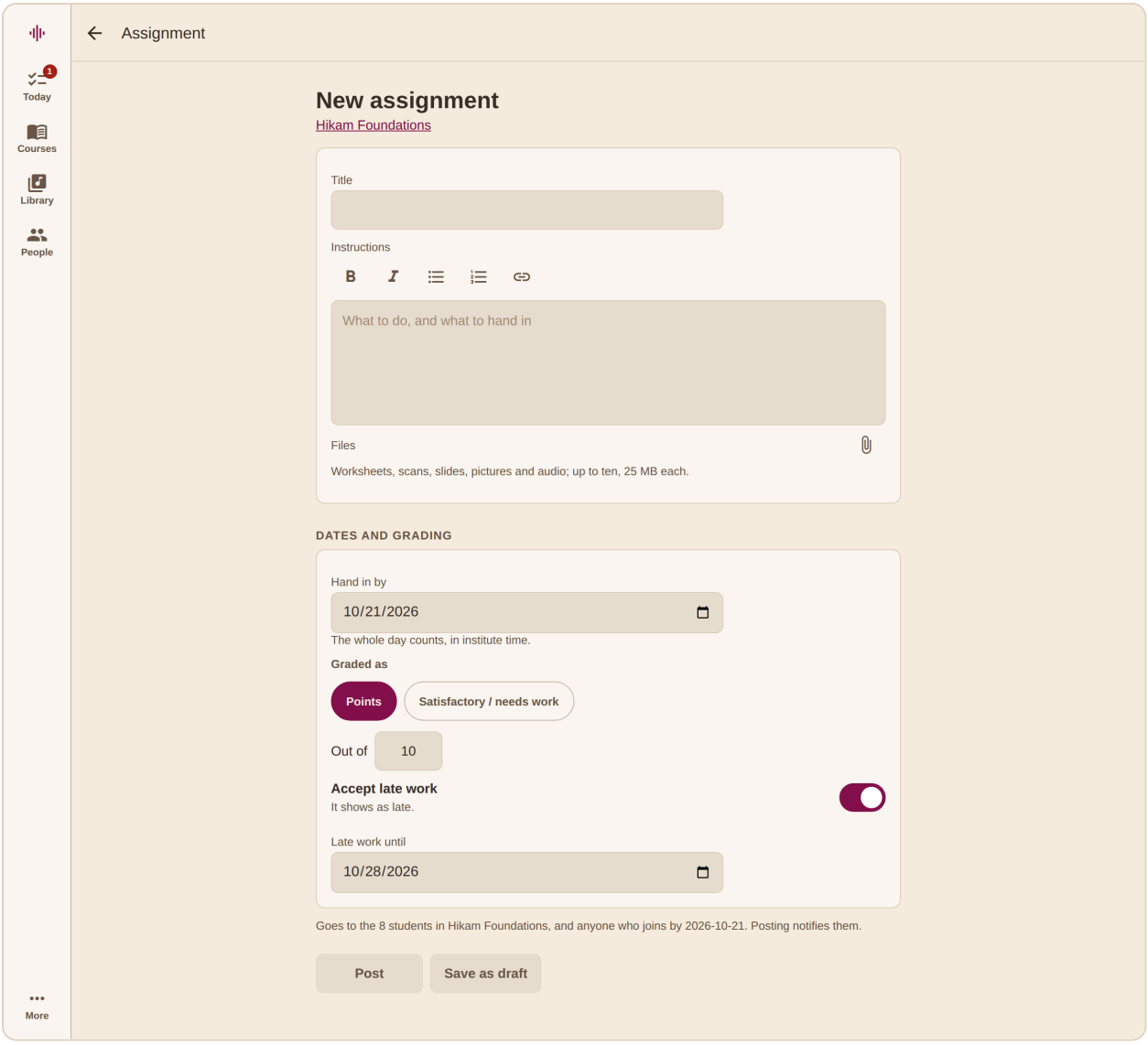


On a computer

Assignments on a course page lists the course's assignments: drafts first, then the rest with the latest due date first. Each card says where the class stands — how many have handed in, and what is waiting on you (**to grade**, **to return**, in gold) apart from what is waiting on students (**past due**, **missed**).


Assignment
New assignment
Hikam Foundations
Title
Instructions
What to do, and what to hand in
Files
Worksheets, scans, slides, pictures and audio; up to ten, 25 MB each.
DATES AND GRADING
Hand in by
10/21/2026
The whole day counts, in institute time.
Graded as
Points
Satisfactory / needs work
Out of
10
Accept late work
It shows as late.
Late work until
10/28/2026
Goes to the 8 students in Hikam Foundations, and anyone who joins by 2026-10-21. Posting notifies them.
Post
Save as draft
Today
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

Tap the + (New assignment):

- **Title** and **Instructions**. Bold, italics, both kinds of list and links are on the bar above the box, and Arabic runs right to left. Select some words and tap the link button to make them a link.
- **Files**: the paperclip adds worksheets, scans, slides, pictures and audio; up to ten, 25 MB each. Add them as you write — they are kept with the assignment when you save or post it, and thrown away with it if you leave without saving. **Post** and **Save** wait until every file is up. Audio you add for the class can be up to 15 minutes, and there is no video.
- **Hand in by** — a week from today to begin with. The whole day counts, in institute time.
- **Graded as** — **Points** out of any whole number, or **Satisfactory / needs work**. This cannot change once a grade has been saved.
- **Accept late work** — on to begin with, until a week after the due date. Late work shows as late; after the last day it is missed.

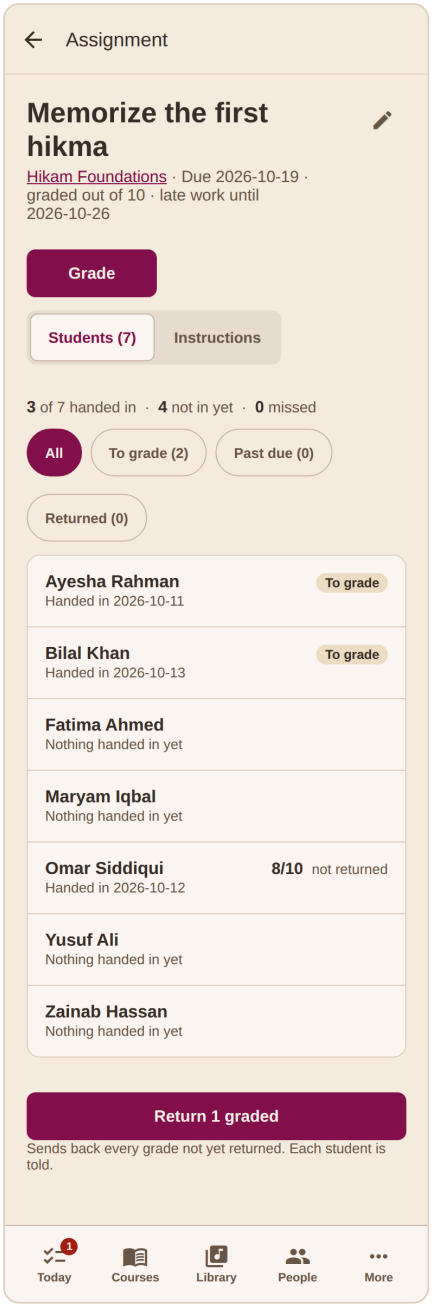
Post sends it to everyone enrolled and tells them; the line above the buttons says how many that is. Anyone who joins the class by the due date gets it too; anyone who joins after does not. **Save as draft** keeps it for the course's staff only, until you post it.

Changing it later. Open it and tap the **pencil**. A new due date reaches everyone still working on it, and tells them — except a student you gave more time, who keeps their own date. If someone else changed the assignment while you had it open, your save is refused and says so, so their change is not lost; open it again to see it. If you leave the form with changes you haven't saved, the app asks before discarding them.

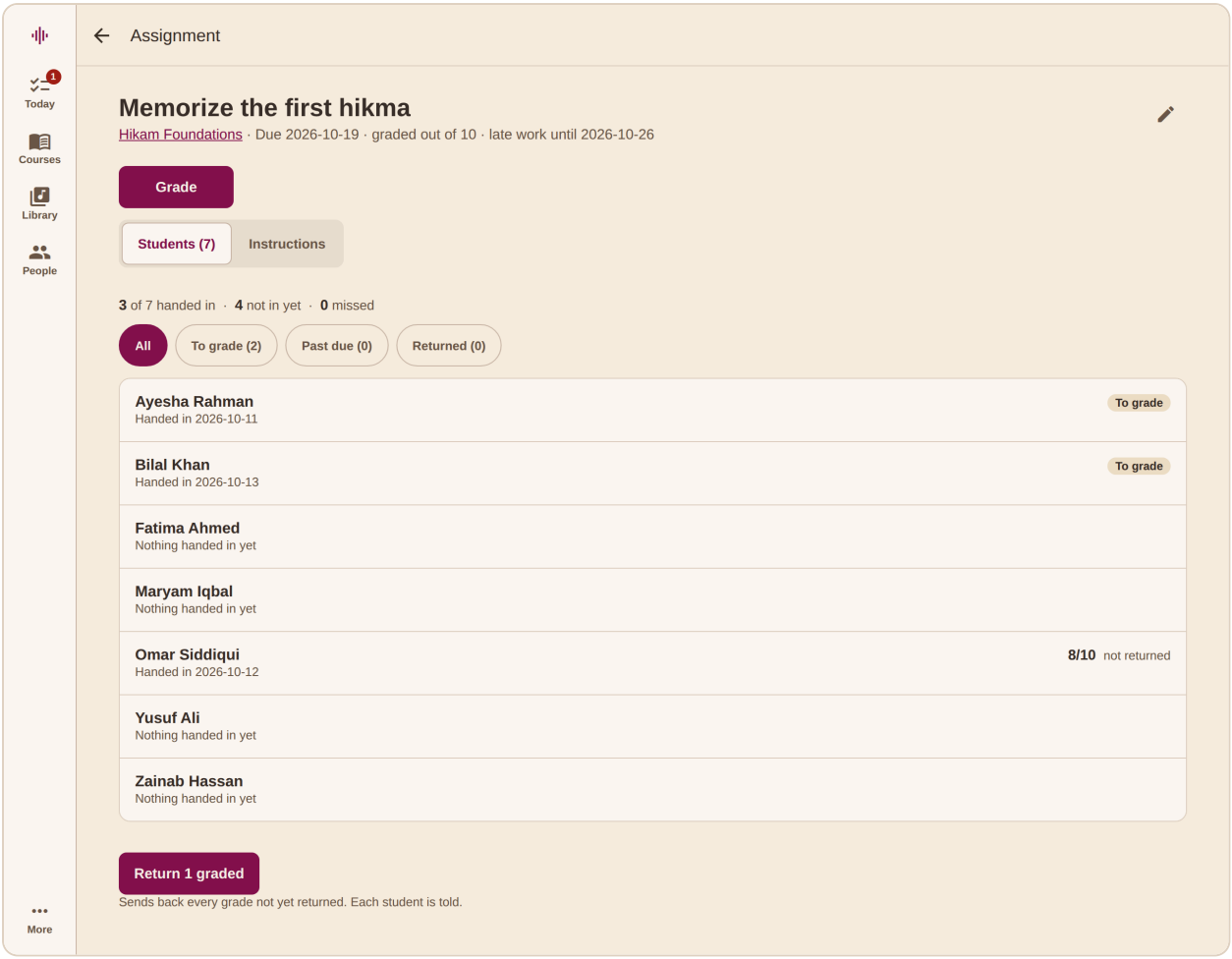
Stop taking work closes it now: everyone with nothing handed in shows as missed, and work already in can still be graded.

Delete assignment, at the foot of the form, is for a mistake: a teacher can delete an assignment only while no student has started it. Once any student has a draft, a hand-in, a grade or a mark on it, only an admin can — close it instead, which keeps the record.

2.15 Grading and returning work

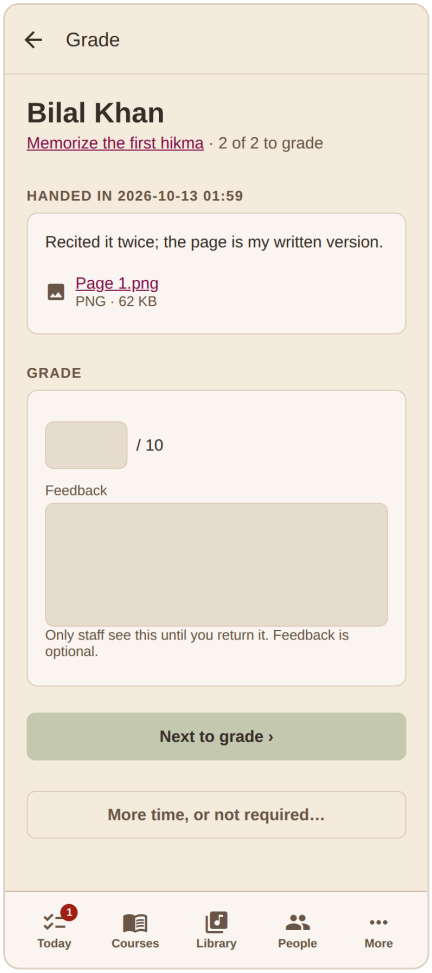


On a phone

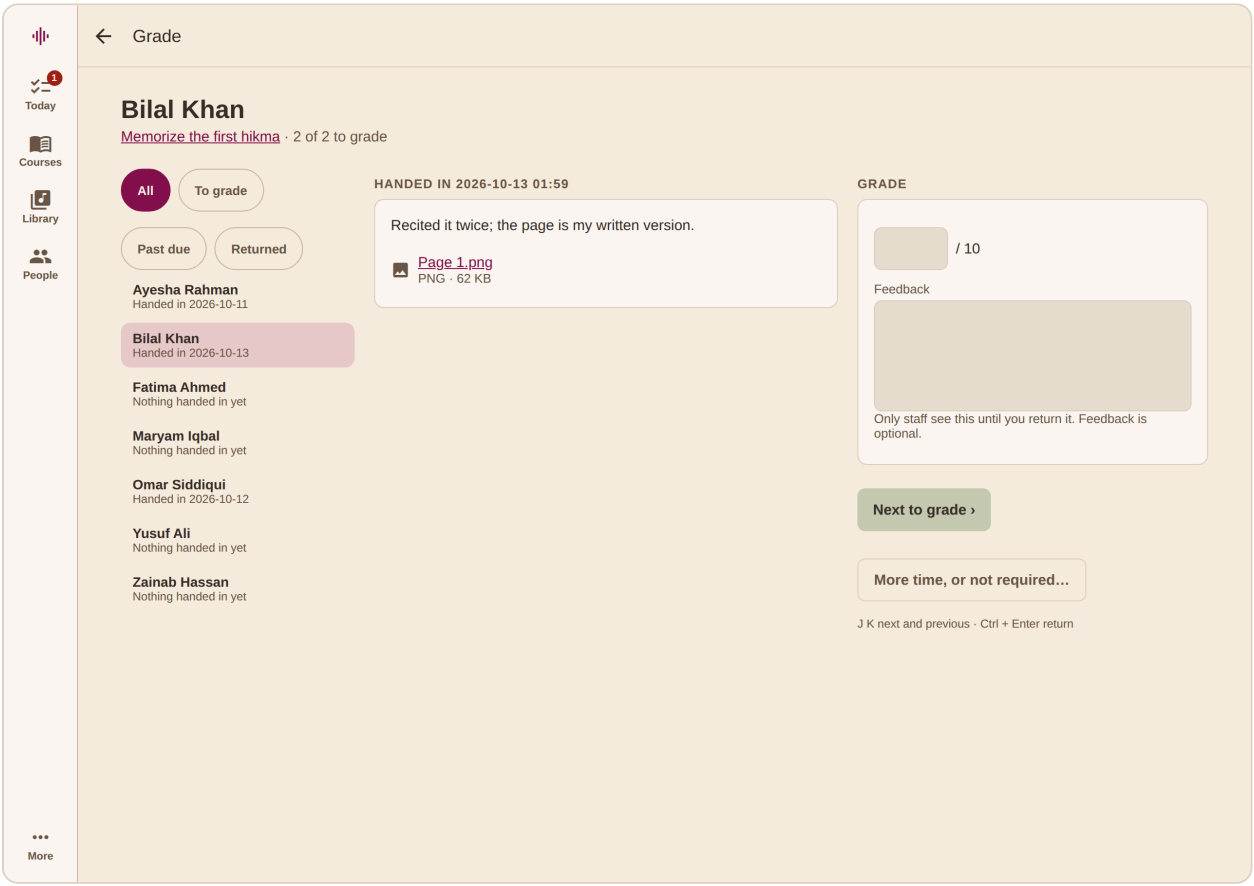


On a computer

Open an assignment to see the class: one line of counts — how many of the class have handed in, how many are not in yet (**past due** once the date has gone), and how many missed — then the students by name, with filters for **To grade**, **Past due** and **Returned**. The list remembers its filter while you grade and come back. **Instructions** shows the assignment as students see it.



On a phone



On a computer

Tap **Grade**, or a student, to open their work: when it was handed in, their answer and their files — tap one to open it — and, once there has been more than one hand-in or take-back, the **hand-in history**, each with its time. Under it:

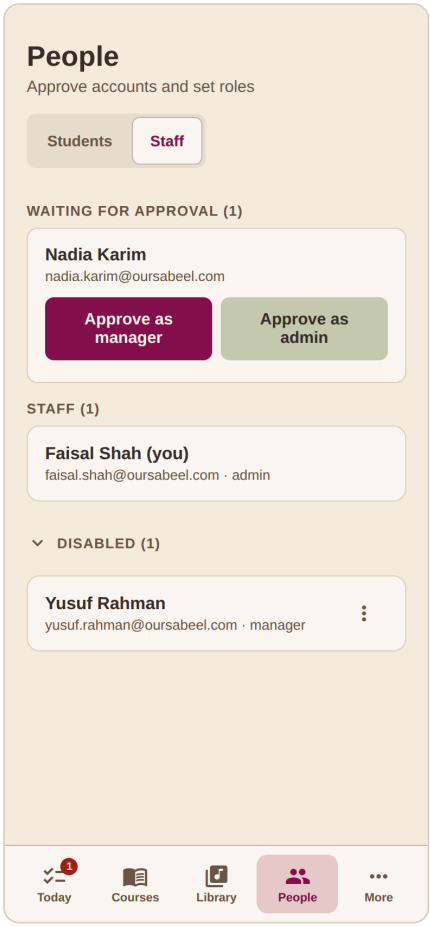
- **The grade and feedback** save as you type, as a draft only staff see. A student sees nothing until you return it.
- **Next to grade ›** moves on to the next student waiting, in name order.
- **Return now** sends this one back at once: the student sees the grade and the feedback and is told it is back. **Ask for another try…** returns it with a new date to hand in again by; this attempt, its grade and its feedback stay with the next one.
- **More time, or not required…** gives this student a date of their own, or lets them off this assignment, each with a reason the student sees.
- Work done on paper or recited in class can be graded with nothing handed in.

On a computer the class list, the work and the grade sit side by side. **J** and **K** move to the next and previous student in the list, and **Ctrl + Enter** (**⌘ + Enter** on a Mac) returns the work on screen — never a single key, so a stray one sends nothing. Moving on and returning always store what you typed first, so nothing is lost by going quickly; if a grade can’t be saved, the screen says so and asks before you leave it.

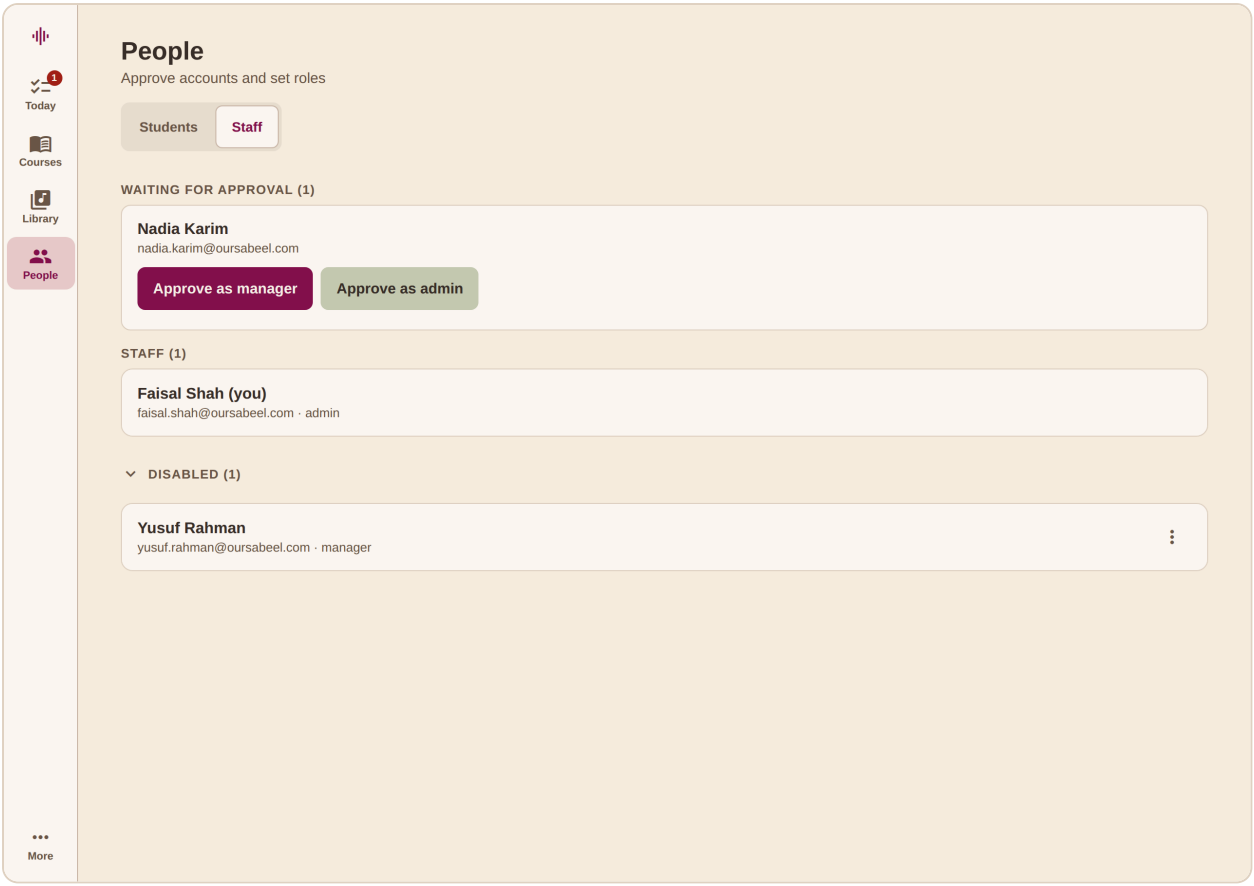
Returning together. Back on the assignment’s page, **Return N graded** sends back every grade not yet returned, at once. The app asks once more first, because a return cannot be taken back. Changing a grade after it has been returned reaches the student at once, tells them, and is recorded in the audit history.

Part 3 — For admins

3.1 Approving staff



On a phone



On a computer

Open **People** and switch to **Staff**. New staff who sign in with Google land in **Waiting for approval**. For each, you choose the role as you approve:

- **Approve as manager** — they can run the courses you later assign to them.
- **Approve as admin** — full access, including approving other staff.

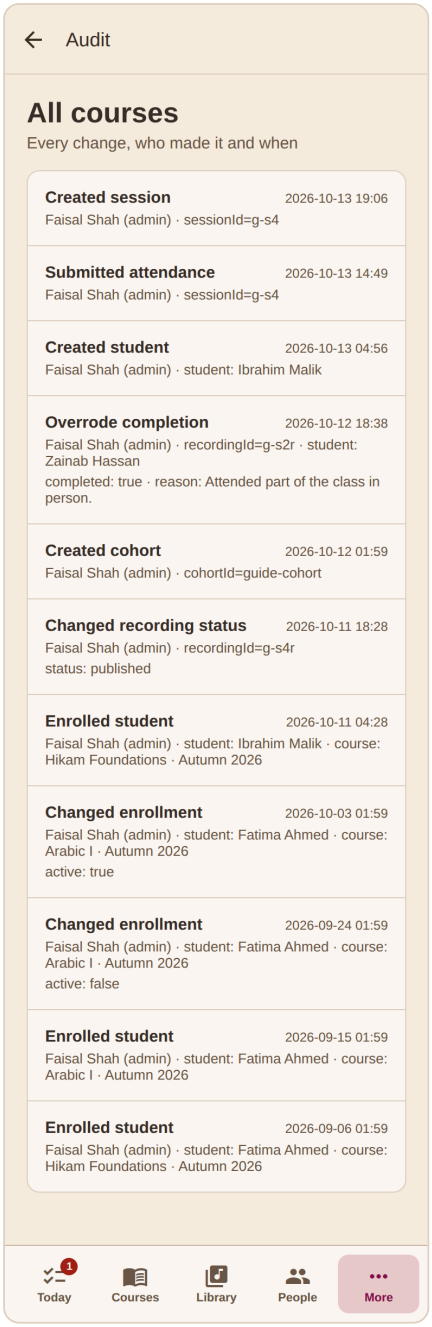
Below, **Staff** lists everyone with access, one line each with their address and role. The ⋮ at the end of a row changes their role or disables them. Your own row is marked *(you)* and has no ⋮ — you can't change your own role or access, which stops an admin from accidentally locking themselves out. Staff you've disabled move out of that list into a **Disabled** section at the bottom, exactly as disabled students do — tap the heading to open it; **Re-enable** is in the row's ⋮.

Only staff on the institute's own Google domain can be approved at all — the app checks this on the server, not just in the browser.

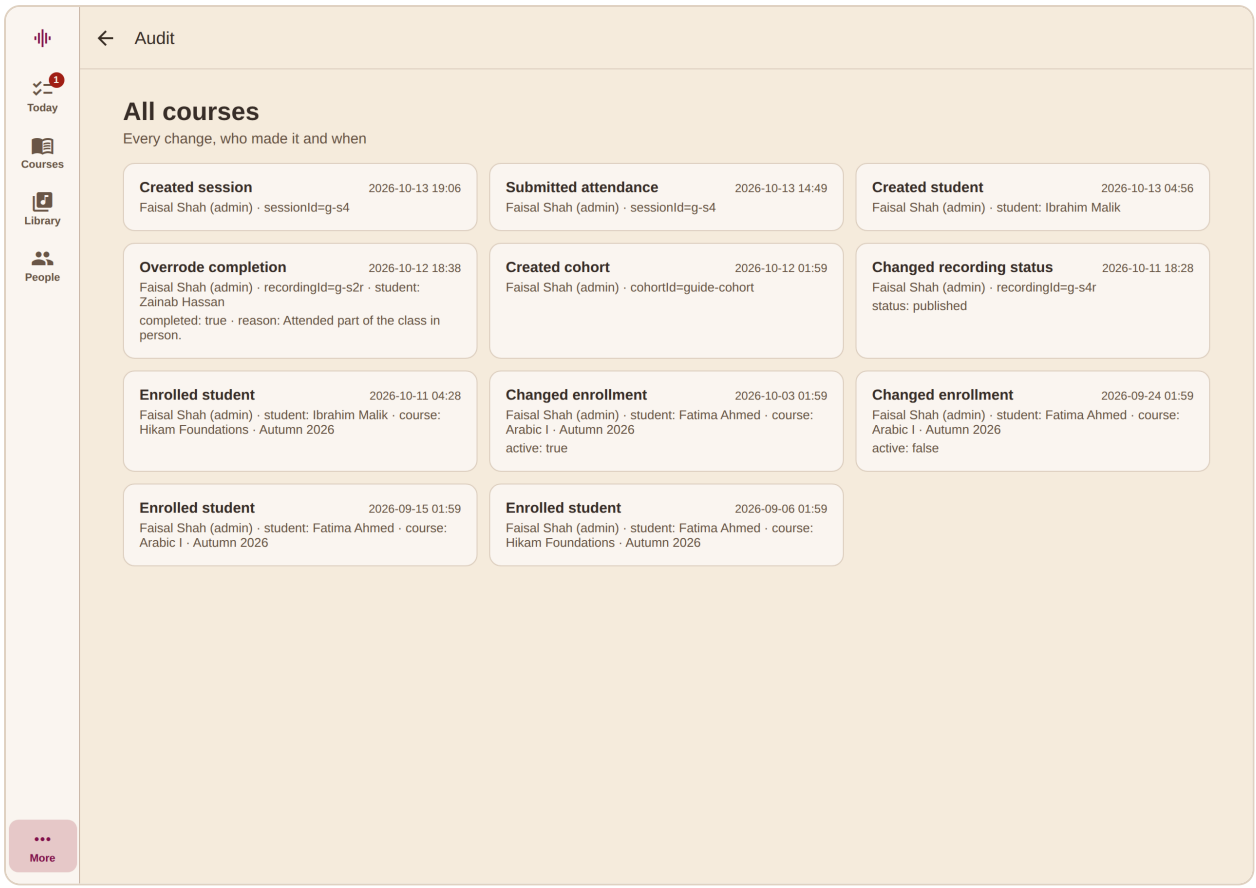
3.2 Managers are scoped course by course

A manager can’t see anything until you give them a course. Do that on the **course page** (Section 2.3), under **Managers** — add them there, and they’ll see that course’s sessions, recordings, ledgers, attendance, and audit, and nothing else. Putting a course in a cohort a manager works in does *not* grant access; the assignment is always the specific course.

3.3 The audit history



On a phone



On a computer

The **audit history** is the running record of consequential actions — staff approvals, attendance submissions, completion overrides (with their reasons), recording edits, and assignments posted, edited, closed, deleted and returned, with any change to a returned grade — newest first. A grade becomes a record when it is returned; drafts change constantly while a teacher works and are not logged keystroke by keystroke. What students do with assignments is kept on their work instead (Section 2.15). Each entry shows *who* did *what*, *when*, and the details that matter.

You can reach it two ways: **globally** from **More → Audit history** (admins, all courses), or **scoped to one course** from that course's page (managers see their own courses' history). It's there so that "who marked this complete, and why?" always has an answer.

Times are the institute's, not your device's — the same clock as every due date, so the two are comparable wherever you are reading from. The screen shows a fixed number of the most recent changes and says how many when it is full; nothing is deleted, and older history is still in the record.

3.4 Disable and archive — don’t delete

The app is built around **reversible** actions:

- **Disable** a student or staff member to switch off access while keeping their history. It ends their session and stops reminders reaching their phone.
- **Unpublish** a recording to pull it from students without losing it, or **archive** it when it should stay closed. Both close it to the students who were excused and take it out of the course totals — its own **Progress** page keeps the record; archiving is the one you reach for when nothing is wrong with the recording itself.
- **Archive** a course when a term ends — every count stays, and you decide whether its recordings stay open. This, not archiving its recordings, is how a term is closed. Its assignments close too, and stay on record.
- **Stop taking work** on an assignment rather than deleting it; a teacher can delete one only while no student has started it.

Permanent deletion exists, but it’s deliberately admin-only, asks for strong confirmation, and is audited. Reach for disable, unpublish, or archive first.

Part 4 — “How do I…?” quick answers

I want to…	Do this
Catch up on a class I missed	**To do** → tap the card → big round button.
Switch between video and audio	Tap the version under the player — you carry on from the same moment.
Pick up where I left off	Just reopen it — your place is saved automatically, on any device.
Slow down or speed up	Choose the speed beside the times on the player.
Mark something done	Press play once, then **Mark complete** at the bottom of the player.
See my attendance for a class	**Classes** → tap the class.
Set my student password	Open the emailed link, or tap **Email me a password link** on sign-in.
Hand in an assignment	**To do** → the assignment → write your answer and/or add files with the paperclip → **Hand in**.
Change what I handed in	Open it → **Take back** (until the due date, and before it is returned) → change it → **Hand in**.
See my grade	It appears on the assignment once your teacher returns it.
Add a session *(staff)*	Course → **Sessions** → **+** → title + date → **Create session**.
Take attendance *(staff)*	Session → mark Present / Absent / Excused → **Submit attendance**.
Add a recording *(staff)*	Open the session → **Import from Zoom** → tick files or a quick pick → **Import**. Or **Upload files…** → choose → **Upload N files**.
Hide a version from students *(staff)*	Session → the **eye** beside the file.
Open a recording to students *(staff)*	Mark them **Excused**, then **Publish** — that is the whole of it.
Change the closing date *(staff)*	Session → the **pencil** → **Due by**. Moving it forward reopens a closed recording.
See who’s behind *(staff)*	Session → **Progress** → **Not complete** / **Missed**.
Post an assignment *(staff)*	Course → **Assignments** → **+** → title, instructions, date → **Post**.

I want to…	Do this
Grade and return *(staff)*	The assignment → **Grade** → grade + feedback → **Return now**, or **Next to grade ›** and **Return N graded** at the end.
Give one student more time *(staff)*	Their work → **More time, or not required…** → reason + date → **Give more time**.
Give someone credit anyway *(staff)*	Ledger → the **pencil** on their row → reason (required) → **Mark complete**.
Make a latecomer catch up on an old session *(staff)*	Open that session → mark them **Excused** → **Submit attendance**. (Move **Due by** forward first if it has passed.)
See course attendance *(staff)*	Course → **Attendance report** (toggle by session / by student).
Export a course for records *(staff)*	Course page → **Export workbook**.
Export one student's record *(staff)*	**People** → the student → ⋮ → **Export workbook**.
Turn a notification off	**More** → **Notifications** → tap the one you don't want.
Approve a new teacher *(admin)*	**People** → **Staff** → **Approve as manager / admin**.
Give a manager a course *(admin)*	Course page → **Managers** → add them.
Create a student *(staff)*	On the website: **People** → **+** → name + email → **Create account**.
See who changed what *(admin)*	**More** → **Audit history**.

Troubleshooting

I signed in but I'm stuck on an "approval" screen. *(Staff)* New accounts wait for an admin to approve them. The screen updates by itself the moment they do — no refresh needed. If you're stuck, contact your administrator.

A student can't sign in. Check the email address matches the one on their account exactly, then open their page from the People screen and use **Resend password link**, in the ⋮ beside their name, so they can set a fresh password. New students have no password until they use that link.

A recording won’t play. Streaming needs a working connection — try switching between Wi-Fi and mobile data, or to **Audio only**, which needs far less of it. Play links refresh automatically, so simply reopening the recording usually clears a stale one.

A student says they shouldn’t be on the hook for a recording. Check that session’s attendance — what is required follows it. If they were there, mark them **Present** and re-submit; the obligation drops (and any progress they made is kept). If they genuinely missed it, that’s exactly what the required listing is for.

I marked something complete but it still shows incomplete. If you were offline, the app is holding your mark and will sync it once you’re back online; it may briefly show as pending. If a *teacher* has overridden your status, their mark takes precedence — that’s by design.

A manager can’t see a course. Managers only see courses they’re assigned to. An admin adds them under **Managers** on the specific course page — being in the cohort isn’t enough.

Where did a recording go? It may have been **unpublished** (back to draft) or its course **archived**. Both are reversible — check the session or the course settings. If the session’s due date has passed, move it forward before publishing again; the card on the session says so.